

## EcoVital Sustainable Solutions



### Contact

Email: [ecovital.ss@gmail.com](mailto:ecovital.ss@gmail.com)



**Joan Jylanne**  
Manager of Policy Planning  
Community Development  
Department

Dear Ms. Jylanne,

We would like to thank you for the opportunity to participate in the affordable housing project with the City of Cambridge. Attached below you will find our report to solve the affordable housing crisis in Cambridge. Our report has conducted both case study analysis and socio-economic analysis to find the best solution tailored to Cambridge. Our report will explain why we believe the recommendations are going to work for Cambridge and how this will be economically feasible.

Our goal is to implement missing middle through various tools such as inclusionary zoning, public-private partnerships, repurposing infrastructure and revitalization. To ensure our solution is accessible to everyone and to minimize gaps of vulnerable groups such as women, immigrants etc. we suggest the implementation of supplementary programs. These programs will also aid in long-term affordability through the reduction of household expenditures. Additionally, a survey was conducted to address the concerns of Cambridge citizens to increase public acceptance.

We believe that our deliverable will fit the needs of the City's request. Your continuous partnership between Wilfrid Laurier University and the City of Cambridge is much appreciated. If any questions or concerns arise, please reach out to our email, [ecovital.ss@gmail.com](mailto:ecovital.ss@gmail.com).

Sincerely,  
EcoVital Sustainable Solution



## Executive Summary

We are EcoVital Sustainable Solutions, a student operated consulting group based in Waterloo whose approach to affordable housing is through addressing the missing middle. The missing middle refers to medium-density housing; these houses are less prominent in Ontario due to regulations, especially development restrictions and fees. This issue has been addressed in other Canadian cities, and we have analyzed these cities which has provided insight on the implementation of missing middle homes. To ensure ease of implementation we conducted a survey to gather public opinion on Cambridge characteristics and housing types. These concerns were then addressed to minimize misconceptions and create public acceptance.

Thus, we have taken a holistic approach which targets intensification through supplying missing middle homes with inclusionary zoning and repurposing current infrastructure and providing alternative housing options with revitalization. Finally, we have gathered supplementary programs which address a range of issues related to affordability with the purpose of improving livelihoods and increasing affordability of the implementation of our main two recommendations. Our recommendations are all supported by building capacity with private-public partnerships.



**EcoVital**

# **Final Deliverable**

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*March 16<sup>th</sup>, 2022*

Ariana Mansingh, Jacqueline Haynes, Gregory  
Nelson, Alia Essipov, Sydney Porte



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## INTRODUCTION

A Request for Proposals (RFP) was created by the City of Cambridge to address their affordable housing crisis. Currently, an increasing number of people are struggling to find affordable housing across Ontario, and Cambridge is no exception. Inflation has only exacerbated an already worsening problem. As a result of the complexity of this issue, there must be a consideration of the various contributing factors such as development costs, Ontario's investor's market, and land availability. The objective of the RFP is to provide a solution that ensures long-term housing affordability, which can be done through attainable or affordable housing. Affordable housing is defined as households that spend 30% of their income or less on housing. While attainable housing is defined as housing for low to moderate-income households, priced at or below the average market rent (CMHC, 2018). Notably, attainable housing includes public housing, not-for-profit housing, cooperative housing and rent supplement programs. In 2016, almost a quarter of Cambridge's population did not have access to affordable housing (Statistics Canada, 2017). Thus, the City is looking for a unique and financially manageable solution that is suitable for Cambridge.

EcoVital Sustainable Solutions has assessed possible resolutions through conducting case study analyses at both the national and international level. From these studies, we have pin-pointed the best practices of case studies' solutions which can be applied to Cambridge. However, socio-economic differences between Cambridge and each case study must be understood as this plays a key role in the effectiveness and implementation of solutions. An additional consideration is public opinion and perception. If the solution is not accepted, this could cause conflicts during the planning and implementation stage. To account for this, we conducted a survey. This will aid in ensuring that our solution gains increased public acceptance and is applicable within the context of Cambridge. Our proposal considers all the factors that affect household expenditures and prices in order to produce a long-term affordable solution for Cambridge citizens.

## Team Philosophy/Approach

The purpose of this report is to evaluate existing policies and actions that have successfully been implemented into different locations and have comparable demographics to Cambridge, Ontario. These findings and best practices will serve as a guide for the City of Cambridge to aid in their continuous efforts of implementing affordable housing initiatives. The findings provide the backbone for each recommendation, and the case studies identified have been hand-picked to meet the current needs of the City. Feasibility is assessed by the investigation of key success factors, complemented by the current needs of the City, and the socio-economic relations of each case. The recommendations presented in this report will give the City a range of strategies designed to meet the current affordable housing needs while also expanding capacity to address long-term needs.

### Team Identification

Our team consist of 5 students who have a diverse set of skills allowing us to create a holistic solution for the affordable housing crisis. The team can be seen in Table 1 which depicts the reasoning for their role and their headshots.

Table 1: Team identification with headshots

| Headshot                                                                           | Name              | Roles                    | Reasoning                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|--------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|   | Ariana Mansingh   | Project Manager          | Has multiple experiences in leading research projects allowing for the use of required skills such as delegating tasks and communication. Additionally, has experience in various fields, thus able to aid in the research of other group members. |
|  | Jacqueline Haynes | Communication Specialist | Has the experience serving as a point of contact for various parties and managing conflict resolution. Has experience in community outreach programs, and skilled in public speaking through previous experiences.                                 |
|  | Greg Nelson       | Economic Analyst         | Experience in population and economic analysis through prior research. Further experience in working with numbers, analyzing data, and making determinations based on the results through past projects.                                           |
|  | Sydney Porte      | Research Analyst         | Conducted many studies throughout school and during work at the City of Port Colborne to create a council report. Experienced in analysis of academic papers to locate relevant information.                                                       |
|  | Alia Essipov      | Graphic Designer         | Proficient in photographic, digital, social media graphic, and video editing software. Extensive experience in designing content for marketing purposes and Adobe Creative Suite.                                                                  |

## Target Market

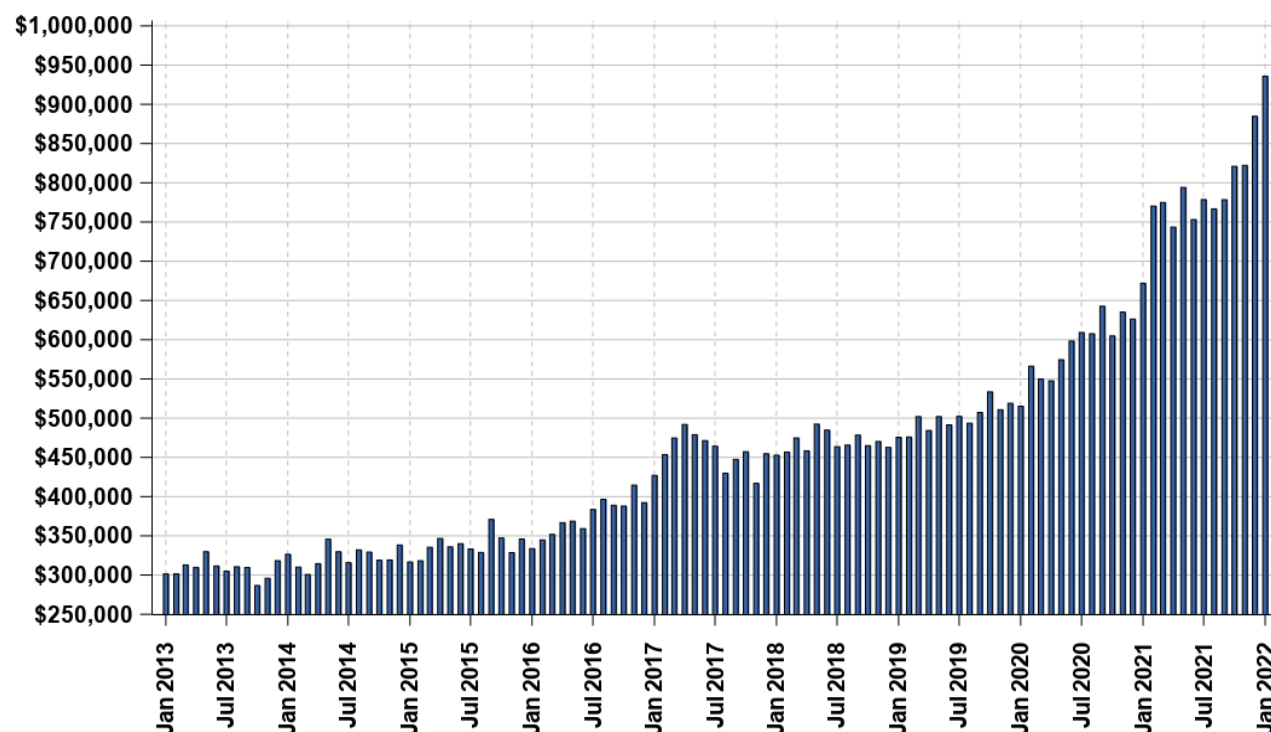
The target audience for our project is first-home buyers, as many individuals are struggling to enter the market due to low supply, limited knowledge on the housing market and inflation. This group is vulnerable to scams or having their rights violated due to their limited experience and knowledge of the market. Currently, due to the drastic increase in the housing market, many buyers are opting out of home inspections as a preventative measure from missing their opportunity of purchasing the home. In turn, putting inspectors out of work and consequently putting first home buyers at risk (King, 2022).

## BACKGROUND:

### *Outline of Cambridge*

Although housing is a human right, inflation has caused housing to be inaccessible to many. This can be linked to how housing prices have increased exponentially in Cambridge, while minimum wage has only experienced a linear increase which is shown below in Figure 1 and 2 (CREA, 2022; Statistics Canada, 2017). This pattern is expected to continue for both housing prices and minimum wage, further increasing barriers for residents to obtain affordable housing.

### Residential average price Cambridge



Source: The Canadian Real Estate Association

Figure 1: Average price of housing in Cambridge from January 2013 to January 2022 (CREA, 2022)



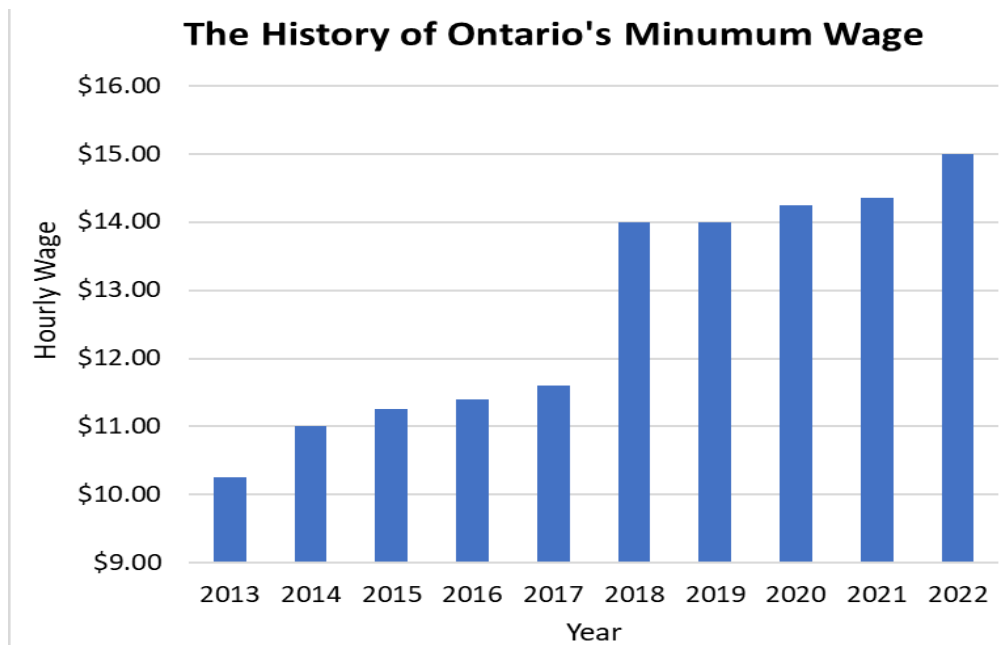


Figure 2: Ontario's hourly minimum wage from 2013 to 2022 (Statistics Canada, 2017)

Looking into the current state of the housing market, as of January 2022, there has been a 4.8% decline compared to January 2021 in the number of homes sold through the MLS® System of the Cambridge Association of REALTORS® (CREA, 2022). Overall, the inventory of new supply available is at an all-time low according to the president of the Cambridge Association of REALTORS® (2022). In fact, the month of January displayed that home sales were 3.5% under the five-year average, and 7.6% below the 10-year average (2022). It is difficult to quantify market conditions using average or median measurements, thus, the Home Price Index (HPI) is used to evaluate price trends with more accuracy. Another form of quantification are benchmark prices, which are used to define the price of a typical home in a set area (2022). The overall MLS® HPI benchmark price in January 2022 was \$940,700 (2022). Specifically, the benchmark price on a year-by-year basis of a single-family home increased 44.1% (now \$971,700), townhouse/row unit increased 35% (now \$655,800), and apartment increased 27.9% (now \$713,300) (2022).

### Existing Challenges

The solutions to housing affordability are not always obvious, and there are three main factors as to why this challenge is hard to tackle. The first is that decreasing household expenditures is not an easy task. There are three types of expenditures: fixed, non-flexible, and flexible (Anacker, 2019). Fixed expenditures include things like rent, health care, etc. (2019). Non-flexible expenditures include transportation, utilities, childcare and more (2019). Flexible expenditures are things like clothing and food (2019). The second challenge is that it is difficult to increase household income. Two options prevail, in which one is to send more household members into the workforce and the other is to successfully find employment opportunities with higher pay (2019). Finally, household expenditure and income slowly grow over time, indicating that budgeting will not solve the main issue. Overall, there is not much opportunity to tackle these challenges without additional help from the government.

## Socio-economic of Cambridge

A thorough analysis of the City of Cambridge's 2016 census was conducted. This was done to construct an accurate and informational socio-economic breakdown. Figure 3 depicts the population growth of Cambridge. Notably, in 2016 the city's population was approximately 130,000 people, and has since increased up to 140,000. Understanding Cambridge's growth rate allows us to ensure this project would support future growth. Population and employment in Cambridge are expected to continue increasing (Cambridge Official Plan, 2018). Thus, implementation of affordable housing cannot solely address the current needs but must account for population increase. In fact, by 2031, Cambridge's population is projected to reach 176,000 people with an estimate of 102,500 jobs (Cambridge Official Plan, 2018). As the economy grows, more people will move to the city looking for housing. Therefore, the importance of understanding the growth rate, forming a proactive solution, and applying it to new housing is more important now than ever before.

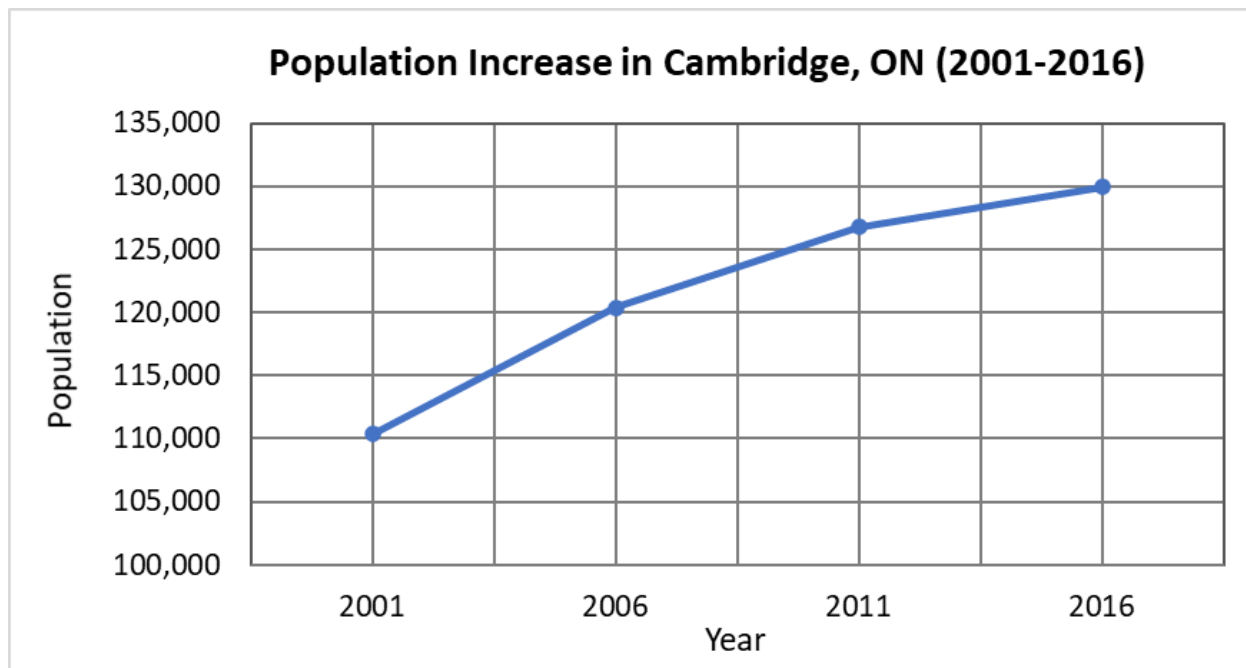


Figure 3: Graph depicting the population in Cambridge from 2001 to 2016 (Statistics Canada, 2017)

As seen in Figure 4, the age demographic in Cambridge follows the pattern of an aging population pyramid. This means that there will be fewer people in the future looking for housing, as many of Cambridge's citizens are retired or seeking to retire in the near future. The main implication is through accommodating the older population. Indeed, with many older people in the community, there is an increase in the number of volunteers helping in the community. The elderly tends to be more financially stable and find pleasure in volunteering. However, problems with an aging population include the increase in competitiveness for jobs. The labour supply increases, and many younger people will find it difficult to find work and pay for housing. As a result, in the workforce, there is less innovation, as many of the workers are older and will have been

there longer. Thus, careful, long-term strategic planning needs to be implemented to accommodate an aging population.

The largest age group in Cambridge is 50-59, which contains 19,430 citizens, but is only 14.96% of the population (Statistics Canada, 2017). Likewise, ages 40-49 make up 18,860 (14.38%) of Cambridge's population. Notably, there are a lot of schools for younger students, as well as two major universities in the nearby city of Waterloo, which is an indication as to why there are many younger citizens as well. In fact, the age group of 20-29, which is when many people start looking for new housing and start their new careers, has 16,270 people, or 12.52%. Notably, there is only a 2% difference from the largest group of 50-59, indicating a well-balanced aged population (Statistics Canada, 2017).

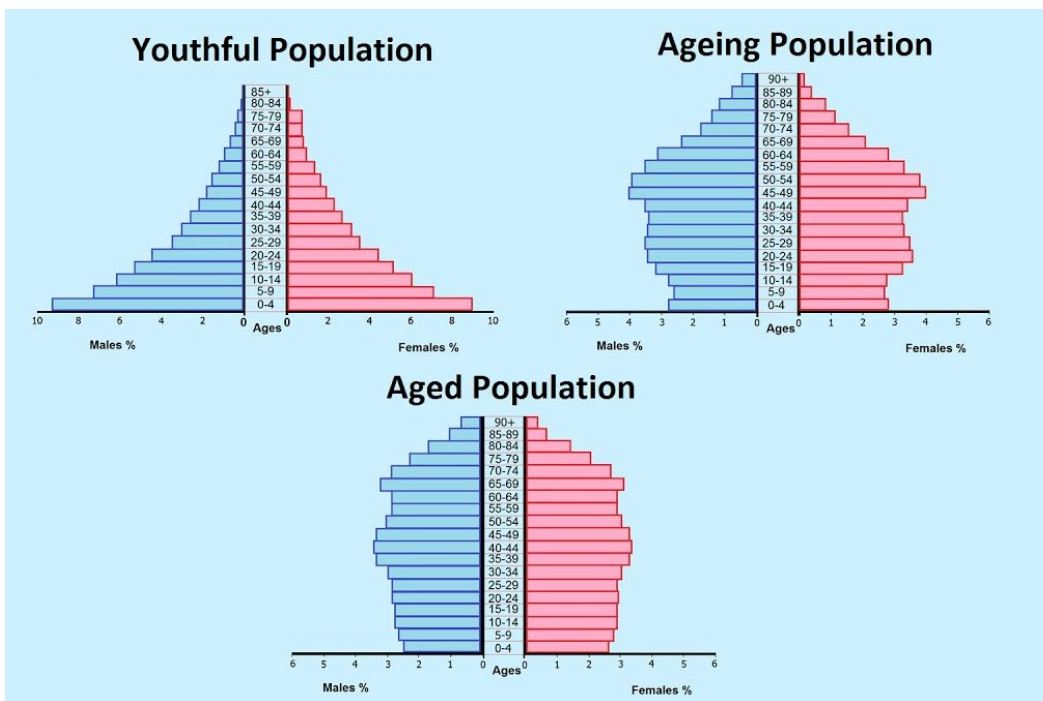


Figure 4: Example population pyramid showing examples of an aged, aging, and youthful population (Darron Gedge's Geography Channel, 2015).

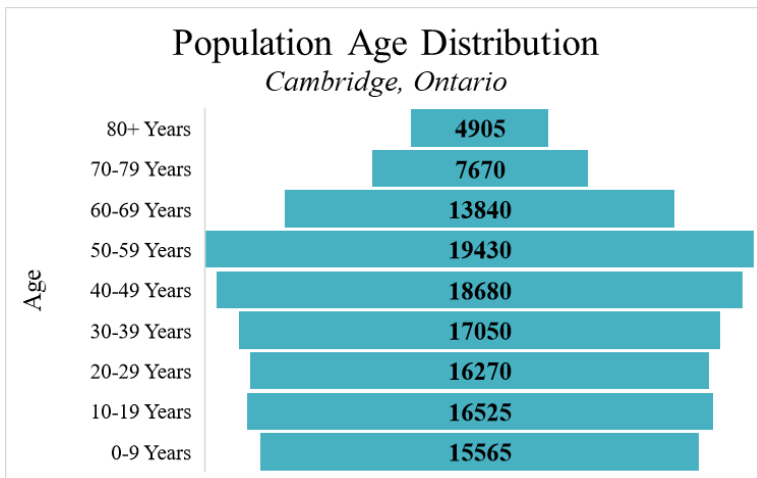


Figure 5: Population pyramid depicting the amount of people in each age range in Cambridge, ON, (Statistics Canada, 2017).

The population in Cambridge is well educated, as 89,550 (61.66%) people have obtained a degree, diploma, or certificate past the high school level, while 15.46% or 22,455 people have not achieved a high school degree at all (Statistics Canada, 2017). Interestingly, 15,775 (10.86%) people have a bachelor or above (Statistics Canada, 2017). Though, this number is still quite low as compared to other cities which have been analyzed, such as Chapel Hill, Boulder, Toronto, and Vancouver which all have higher rates of highly educated citizens, which will be discussed in greater detail later in the report. Importantly, if a city has a higher education rate, citizens will be more likely to secure higher paying jobs, making the need for affordable housing less of a demand. However, as a high number of people remain uneducated, many get stuck working minimum wage jobs and struggle finding an affordable home to live in.

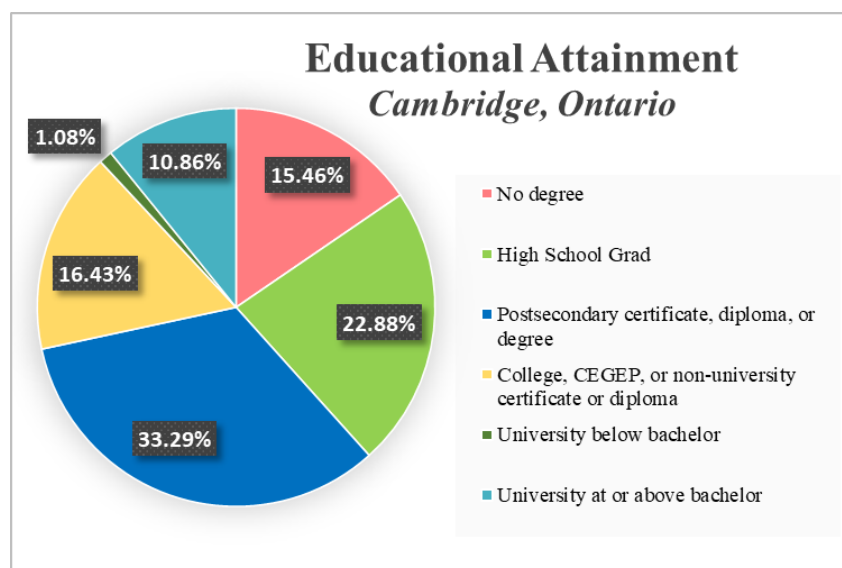


Figure 6: Pie graph showing the education attainment of the Cambridge population, (Statistics Canada, 2017)

In most cases, education is related to higher income. Since the people of Cambridge are mostly well educated, it is understandable that the highest household income group is between \$50,000 to \$99,999 with 23,100 people reporting this income amount or almost 50% of census respondents (Statistics Canada, 2017). Notably, the second largest group is a lower household income bracket, which is between \$10,000 to \$49,999, which contains 13,375 (27.73%) of the respondents (Statistics Canada, 2017). Only 795 people fall below \$10,000, which is only 1.65% (Statistics Canada, 2017). There are also a large number of households that obtain higher incomes. For instance, the income group of \$100,000 to \$149,999 contains 10,150 people (21.04% of respondents) (Statistics Canada, 2017). Therefore, there is an assortment of different household incomes within the City of Cambridge.

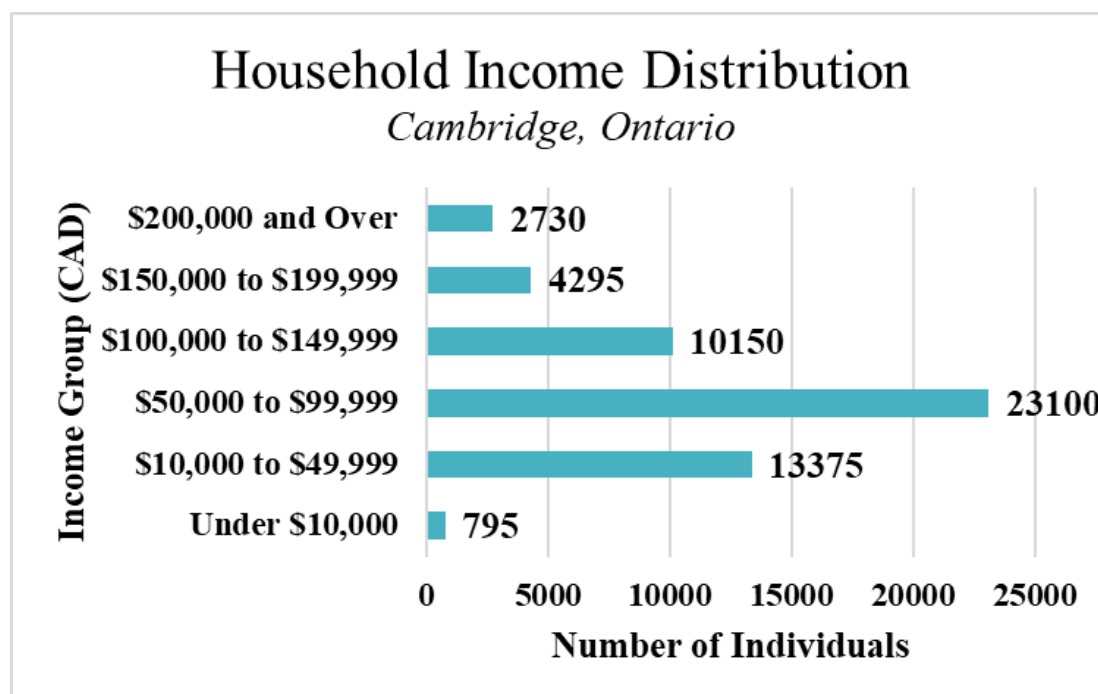


Figure 7: Graph showing the household income distribution of Cambridge, ON, (Statistics Canada, 2017).

Lastly, the City of Cambridge's ethnic origins distribution was analyzed. Ethnic minorities may find it harder to obtain housing and education in different areas, making it important to understand the ethnic minority population as each group faces different hurdles. Most citizens in Cambridge identify as European, with 91,310 (57.52%) people. Identifiably, there are also many Other North American people, with 39,790 (25.06%), which are mostly individuals who identify as Canadian. Another larger group is the Asian and Middle Eastern people. The City of Cambridge houses 15,625 people in this category, which is just under 10% of the population. Certainly, other cities that have a higher ethnic diversity can have a harder time gaining public approval for projects, as there are more opinions amongst the population.

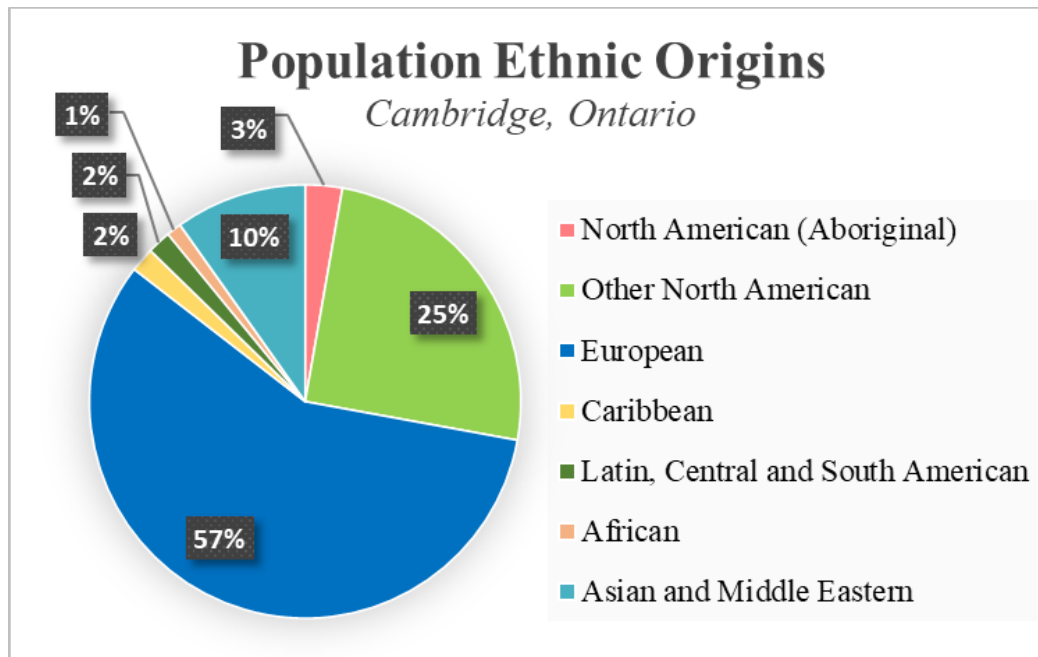


Figure 8: Pie graph depicting the percentage of the population of each ethnic origin, (Statistics Canada, 2017).

### What is the Missing Middle?

The main tool we will use to address housing affordability is the missing middle. The missing middle refers to the limited number of housing in between single-family homes and high-rise buildings as depicted in Figure 9. Housing within the middle includes, but is not limited to, town houses, duplexes, granny flats, etc. Within Ontario, there are limited geographical opportunities for this due to development cost, zoning restriction, etc. (Toronto Regional Real Estate Board, 2020).



Figure 9: Housing type spectrum (Chintis, 2019)



## Limited Opportunities: Development Fees

Development costs play a significant role in why the missing middle exists. It also plays a role in housing costs. Development costs need to be compensated for and this is done by increasing the price of housing. During the construction of a building, there are four types of development costs that occur, which are hard development costs, soft development costs, developer profit, and land acquisition costs. Hard development costs are the materials and labour that are required in the physical construction of a development project. These costs are relatively fixed. On the other hand, soft development costs include all other development costs a developer will face. For example, government-imposed development charges and policies. Developer profit notes that developers need to obtain a certain profit threshold for a development project to be constructed. Essentially, if an acceptable profit margin cannot be met, then developers will seek development in another market. For land costs, the strength of the market in an area is directly correlated to the value of the land. Since 2001, land values have climbed, despite the increases in municipal fees and construction costs. Developers pay less for land if prices stabilize or decline, but costs continue to rise, (NBLC, 2020)

To best understand why housing development typically excludes the missing middle can best be seen through a comparison of the condominium application fee and the plan of subdivision; these fees are categorized as soft development fees. These are the additional steps necessary for high-rise building construction and missing middle homes, respectively. The reason why these fees are referred to as 'additional' is because there is no equivalent step for single-family home development. The development process for single-family homes is simpler, making it less costly. Moving onto the condominium application, as depicted in Table 2, the regional review fee ranges from \$3,150 to \$6,150 while the same fee for the plan of subdivision ranges from \$6,525 to \$20,000; thus, the former is approximately 2-6 times more expensive (Cambridge Community Development Department, 2022). Overall, the increased cost of subdivision compels developers to build high-rise buildings or single-family homes. As high-rise buildings have less development costs while producing more income for the same amount of land and development fees for single-family homes are much cheaper.

Table 2: Comparison between the development fees for condominium application and plan of subdivision (City of Cambridge, 2022)

| Development Process            | Development Fees                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Condominium Application</b> | <i>Regional Review Fee: \$3,150 + \$100/unit (Maximum \$6,150)</i> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• <i>Standard/Phased Condominium: \$4,600</i></li> <li>• <i>Common Element: \$6,800</i></li> <li>• <i>Vacant Land: \$9,000</i></li> <li>• <i>Conversion: \$9,000</i></li> </ul> |
| <b>Plan of Subdivision</b>     | <i>Regional Review Fee: \$6,525+\$500/ha (Maximum: \$20,000)</i> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• <i>Base fee: \$10,600 + \$200/unit/ha</i></li> <li>• <i>Maximum Fee: \$22,700</i></li> </ul>                                                                                    |

## National Analysis: Addressing the Missing Middle Toronto, ON

The City of Toronto has introduced two initiatives aimed towards the improvement of the missing middle: the *Beaches East York Pilot Project* and the *HousingTO 2020-2030 Action Plan*. These projects provide three viable solutions for expanding housing opportunities by authorizing zoning sanctions for new types of dwelling, developing additional units, and introducing low-rise housing on major streets. Addressing the missing middle through the two initiatives will effectuate the gap in the housing market, provide accessibility, and introduce a diverse blend of different housing options.

### Best Practices:

- Permitting accessory housing (ex. garden suites, coach houses, etc.)
- Authorization for residential units compatible with existing houses (ex. duplexes, triplexes, etc.)
- Zoning to allow increased low-rise housing options on major streets

Table 3: Breakdown of Beaches East York Pilot Project

| Project/Initiative       | Beaches East York Pilot Project - Jan 19, 2021                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Key Points/Plan          | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Build on recent work in support of secondary and laneway suites, Inclusionary Zoning and dwelling room protections</li> <li>• Collaborate with the community and development industry to develop demonstration models that could be used as a framework for additional sites</li> <li>• Permit additional dwelling in different forms of Missing Middle</li> </ul> |
| Required Approvals       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• May require relief from the Zoning By-law standards through an application to the Committee of Adjustment</li> <li>• May require accompanying Site Plan Control applications</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Planning and Development | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Deliberation with building industry representatives and request for pre qualifications (RFPQ)</li> <li>• Deliberation with the local Councillor and community on RFP criteria and selected sites</li> <li>• Selecting a suitable site and planner/builder</li> </ul> <p>Applications to facilitate the development of Missing Middle housing</p>                   |



Table 4: Breakdown of HousingTO 2020-2030 Action Plan

| Project/Initiative | HousingTO 2020-2030 Action Plan - Dec 2019                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Key Points/Plan    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Approve 40,000 new affordable rental homes which include: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>○ Supportive housing for vulnerable residents including people who are homeless or at risk of being homeless</li> <li>○ Affordable rental and supportive housing dedicated to women and girls including female-led households</li> <li>○ Preventing evictions for low-income households through the City's Eviction Prevention in the Community (EPIC) program</li> </ul> </li> <li>• Improve living conditions by repairing and revitalizing existing home surroundings</li> <li>• Enhance partnerships with Indigenous Community Partners</li> </ul> |
| Policies           | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Establish city-wide zoning authorization for multi-tenant homes</li> <li>• Potential incentives or funding for Section 37 and Inclusionary Zoning requirements</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Cost and Finances  | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Will require investments from all orders of government as well as private and non-profit sectors</li> <li>• Anticipated to cost a total of \$6.4 billion in capital costs and \$300 million in ongoing annual operating costs</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |

### Socio-Economic Comparison

The age distribution among the population of Toronto is relatively more middle aged than Cambridge, which has a large elderly population. Those aged 20-39 comprise 31.07% of the population. Interestingly, for the retired group, which falls between the ages of 60-79, Toronto and Cambridge both have approximately 16.60% of the population in this category. However, it is important to note that Toronto has a much larger population than Cambridge, with 2,731,571 people as of 2016.

In terms of education, Toronto has a more educated population than Cambridge. Similar to Vancouver, Toronto has a wide variety of postsecondary institutions for students to choose from to obtain a higher education. In fact, 23.48% of the city's population has a bachelor's degree or higher, and 38.13% have a postsecondary certificate, diploma, or degree, which are both higher than Cambridge. Notably, there are less people without a degree in Toronto than Cambridge, with only 10.61% of people, which is 5% fewer than Cambridge.

Analyzing Toronto's household income distribution brings interesting results. The highest most common bracket is \$10 000 to \$49 999, which 36.44% of the population falls within. Toronto is known as an expensive place to live, but most of the inhabitants are surviving on low incomes. Likewise, 5.57% of households claim to earn under \$10 000 in annual income. This number is 4% higher than that of Cambridge, which fortunately does not have as much of a low-income crisis amongst the population. On the other hand, there are more wealthy people in Toronto too, with almost 10% of people reporting incomes of over \$200 000 annually (almost 4% higher than Cambridge).

Finally, looking at ethnic origins, Toronto is a very diverse city compared to Cambridge. In fact, it is known to be one of the most diverse cities not only in Canada, but the world (Ahmadi, 2018). Toronto has a higher percentage of Asian and Middle Eastern (33.92%), Caribbean (5.21%), Latin, Central, and South American (3.58%), and African (4.62%) people than Cambridge who has Asian and Middle Eastern (9.84%), Caribbean (1.82%), Latin, Central, and South American (1.77%), and African (1.11%), (Statistics Canada, 2017).

### **Vancouver, BC**

Vancouver has employed the *Making Room: Housing for All of Us* policy to address the affordable housing crisis by pushing density into single-family home neighbourhoods. The initiative to increase medium-density homes also known as, missing middle homes began in 2018 (Connolly, 2018). To ensure Vancouver's long-term survival to this initiative, an analysis was conducted to provide an overarching understanding of socio-economic changes, development approval and zoning. The specific research conducted achieved the following:

- Aggregated data on development approvals since 2010 and upcoming applications.
- Aggregated Statistics Canada's data on population and dwelling growth.
- Accumulated data on the net change in both rental and social units over time.
- Assessed *Housing Vancouver's* information on affordability assumptions.
- Assessed how zoning and development capacity models in the City are used in community planning.
- Aggregated the CMHC's data on the secondary rental market.
- Created a list of all approved social/supportive and rental unit developments since 2010

Source: Kelley, 2021

Using the completed research above, Staff assessed how to incorporate the recalibrated housing targets as well as transparent information into several work programs as follows:

- Understanding Current and Future Housing needs through reviewing the Vancouver Plan Housing targets and coordinate with the updated Regional Growth Strategy (RGS)
- Enhancing public-use data on residential development through the Planning, Development and Legislative Services (PDL) and Development, Buildings and Licensing (DBL) data initiatives

Source: Kelley, 2021

Vancouver passed motion B.3 of the *Making Home: Housing For All of Us* on January 26, 2022 (City of Vancouver, n.d.). This specific motion builds on the previous Council plans outlined above. Section B.3

directs the development of appropriate policies and guidelines aiding in their target of 2000 lots, currently zoned for single-detached homes to allow for up to six units. These lots would be subject to appropriate rezoning and the new policy would:

- Consider modest height increases that are compatible with neighbouring buildings.
- Consider lower floor units to be appropriately below ground level, or 'below-grade'.
- Consider development cost expectations when appropriate such as to limit potential speculative land purchases.
- Consider development cost levies (DCL) to contribute to neighbourhood infrastructure such as water, sewers, roads, active transportation, sidewalks, parks, child care, and affordable housing for households with an annual income of \$80,000 or less.
- Consider appropriate development contributions such as community amenity contributions which can aid in advancing the Climate Emergency Action Plan, community facilities or other public services.
- Consider how tenancies considered for redevelopments could be applicable for the Tenant Relocation and Protection Policy.

Single-family homes, laneway houses, character retention, and duplexes can now be built to increase the density in single-family zonings. Increasing housing availability is Vancouver's top priority (City of Vancouver, n.d.). As such, they have combined social housing initiatives into a \$2-billion endowment fund. This is funded by Vancouver's empty home tax, developer fees and contributions from both the provincial and federal government. This fund will aid in the creation of 12,000 social housing units over the next ten years. These 12,000 units are part of their overall goal to create a mix of 72,000 new units that meet the various demands of the population. Out of the total 72,000, the City plans to build 20,000 (~27.8%) rental apartments, 30,000 (~41.7%) condominiums, 4,000 (~5.6%) rental laneway houses, 1,000 (~1.4%) coach houses and 5,000 (~6.9%) townhouses (St. Denis, 2018). Within five years the City has delivered approximately 47% of the total target which is further explained in Figure 10 (City of Vancouver, 2021).



\*Of the total rental approvals over the last 5 years, 527 units were approved as below-market rental housing achieving 13% of the 10-Year target of 4,000 units.

Figure 10: Vancouver's 2021 progress to Housing Vancouver targets

## Vacancy Tax

Vancouver implemented an 'empty home tax' in 2017 in order to return vacant and unused properties back into the market as long-term rentals for their residents. This process requires homeowners to submit a declaration annually to determine whether the empty home tax should be applied to their properties. In 2017, the tax started as 1% of the property's assessed taxable value and now has raised to 3% (City of Vancouver, n.d.). Scenarios of the market value and various assessment was created to depict the tax amount under a 1% and 2% vacancy tax (Appendix). This tax has provided funding into social housing initiative as mentioned previously, as well as reduced the number of vacant properties as depicted in Table 5. The funding produced from this tax is depicted in Table 6.

Table 5: Quantification of Vancouver's vacancy tax from 2018 to 2020

|                            | 2017    | 2018    | 2019    | 2020    |
|----------------------------|---------|---------|---------|---------|
| <b>Empty</b>               |         |         |         |         |
| <b>Exempt</b>              | 5,479   | 4,327   | 4,221   | 4,227   |
| <b>Vacant</b>              | 2,193   | 2,036   | 1,769   | 1,627   |
| <b>Occupied</b>            |         |         |         |         |
| <b>Principal Residence</b> | 131,432 | 132,723 | 132,911 | 133,062 |
| <b>Tenanted</b>            | 46,934  | 50,076  | 53,216  | 56,096  |
| <b>Total</b>               | 186,038 | 189,162 | 192,117 | 195,012 |

Table 6: Income from the Vancouver's vacancy tax from 2018 to 2021

|                                  | 2018<br>\$ Millions | 2019<br>\$ Millions | 2020<br>\$ Millions | 2021<br>\$ Millions |
|----------------------------------|---------------------|---------------------|---------------------|---------------------|
| <b>Taxy Levy</b>                 | \$38.0              | \$39.4              | \$36.0              | \$26.0              |
| <b>Penalties</b>                 | \$1.1               | \$1.8               | \$1.9               | \$1.8               |
| <b>Total (Tax and Penalties)</b> | <b>\$39.1</b>       | <b>\$41.2</b>       | <b>\$37.9</b>       | <b>\$27.8</b>       |
| <b>Collected</b>                 | <b>\$33.6</b>       | <b>\$23.3</b>       | <b>\$27.9</b>       | <b>\$20.8</b>       |

*Case Study Practice: Vacancy Tax Application*

The [vacancy tax application](#) process is done through the City of Vancouver website; this process takes approximately five minutes and requires the following information.

Required Information:

- Folio number
- Access code

Additional information (varies based off property status)

- Tenant names
- Court order number
- Permit number
- Property status: entails if an individual such as a family member occupied the residence for at least 6 months or rented for 6 months within a period of 30 or more consecutive days.
- Occupancy for full-time employment: If your principal residence is outside of Vancouver but you have resided in the property for at least 6 months because you were employed within the city.
- If the property was undergoing redevelopment or major renovations, vacant land, heritage preservation, phased development
- Owner, permitted occupant, tenant, or subtenant under care: If the occupiers of the resident resided in the hospital or a long-term care facility for 6 or more months.

Source: City of Vancouver, n.d.

*Best Practices*

- Conduction of research
  - List of development approvals and upcoming applications
  - Population analysis
  - Net change in rentals and social units
  - Current and future housing needs
- Creation of accessible public-use data on residential development
- Obtain funding through vacancy tax

Areas Vancouver has identified as best opportunities for change:

- Transit
- Schools
- Shopping Areas
- Parks
- Services & Amenities

Vancouver's risk considerations

- Existing rental residences
- Household Incomes
- High Character Value
- Age of residences
- Tree Canopy
- Utilities

Source: Housing Vancouver, 2018

## Survey

### Methods

Our online survey was administered between January 24th to March 11th, 2022. The main goal of this survey was to obtain local concerns of affordable housing, while also obtaining insight on the characteristics of Cambridge to inform our research. Appendix C depicts our survey, which is broken into 3 sections: Cambridge characteristics, housing, and demography. The survey had 66 total participants for the first section, while 51 responded to the second and third sections.

The Cambridge characteristic section provides insight into the City's strengths and weaknesses. This is done through participants ranking how satisfied they are with various characteristics, such as quality of life, walkability, access to affordable housing etc. Understanding the public's perceived weaknesses of Cambridge allows us to adjust our research and project to accommodate it. For example, if residents state that they believe there are gaps in the transit system, then we would focus our solution around high-density areas.

The housing section (Appendix B: Section C) gauges participants' opinions and concerns with the implementations of affordable and social housing. Social housing is defined as government-assisted housing that provides lower-cost rental units. We evaluated these concerns, in the 'Concerns' section. This section of the survey also gathers insight on the participants' housing situations which entails the type of housing and living conditions. As well as insight on desirable housing features and housing barriers. Understanding the housing situation of participants provides insight into the real estate of Cambridge and allows us to understand the problems associated with each type of housing. Additionally, understanding what characteristics the public desires in a property would allow us to implement these characteristics into our solution.

The demography section collected information on gender, age, ethnicity, and location in Cambridge. This information is gathered for the compatibility analysis, as each of these will produce different effects on the applicability and implementation of solutions, which is further explained in the socio-economic section of each case study. In addition, this information is compared to the 2016 Statistic Canada survey to see how representative our survey is to Cambridge's population.

### Comparison of Survey Demographics to Cambridge's Population

#### Age

Comparing the age demographics of the survey to the 2016 Statistics Canada, we can see the age of the Cambridge population is relatively balanced while the survey sample is skewed towards an increase in the 30-49 age group and decrease in the 65+ age demographic. Hence demonstrating that our results are not representative of Cambridge's population. However, it is representative of the age groups most active in the housing markets, in fact, between 25-35 is when the majority (44%) of individuals in Ontario enter the housing market (Royal LePage Real Estate Services, 2021). Since younger individuals are having difficulty



entering the market, the survey's emphasis on these age demographics could help alleviate these challenges

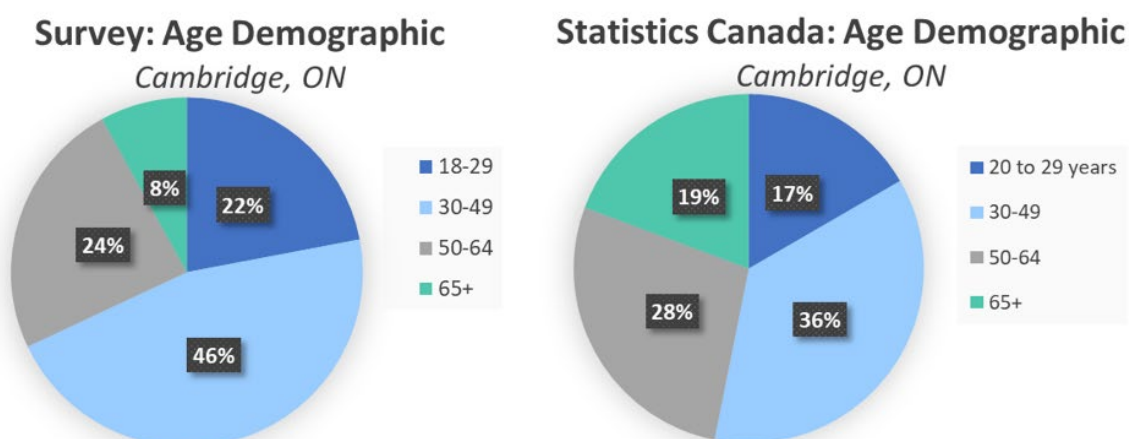


Figure 11: Comparison of survey sample and population age demographic

### Ethnicity

Moving onto the ethnicity demographics, the categories used by survey participants differ from Statistics Canada's categories. However, a comparison can still be made between Caucasian, North American and European origins because Caucasians is a broad term for those who are White or of European origins. Thus, the survey has a similar Caucasian sample to the overall population of Cambridge. The Indigenous representation for both the City's population and the survey sample is the same percentage. The mixed category consists of 2 participants, both stating they are a Caribbean and European mix. We decided to categorize them as "mixed" as putting them in one or the other category or putting them in both categories could present inaccuracy in the data. Additionally, the survey lacks Central/South America and African input. Overall, due to the missing demographic groups, these results should be read with caution as these missing groups may have a separate experience that was not considered. Thus, we suggest further research into the experience of minorities in Cambridge to bridge this gap.

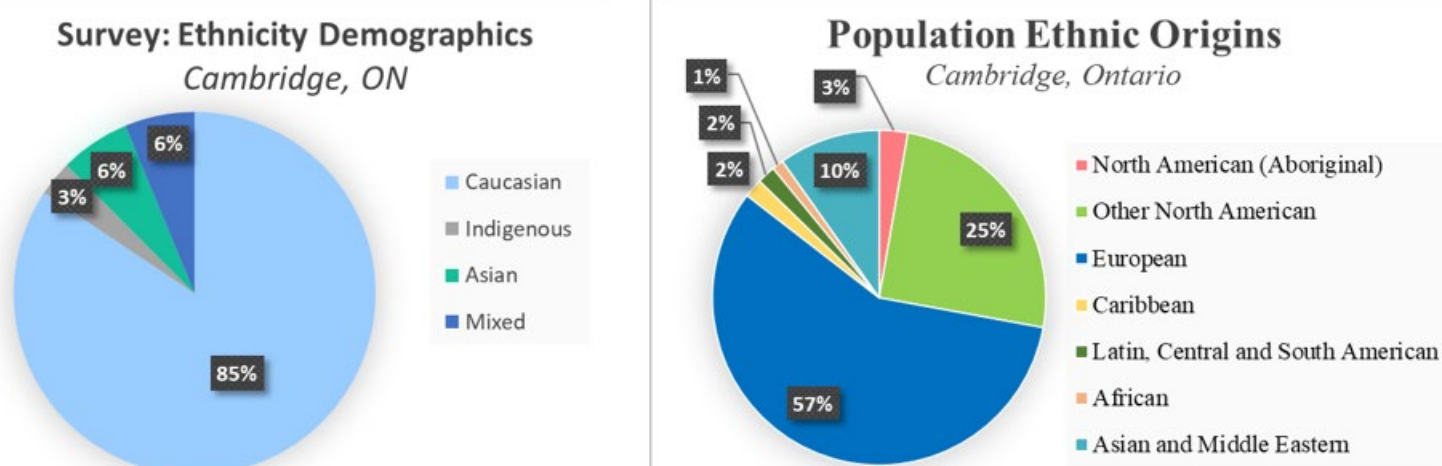


Figure 12: Comparison of survey ethnicity to the population (Statistics Canada, 2017.)



### Income

Before comparing the income demographics, please note that the income groups size differs between our survey and Statistics Canada survey. Due to the difference in groups, we will be addressing the overall pattern of income between the two surveys.

Starting with individual income by gender, both surveys demonstrate a gendered gap in income as women dominate the lower income brackets while men dominate higher income brackets. Thereby illustrating the vulnerability women face in terms of income and obtaining affordable housing. This is a relevant gap that Cambridge will need to consider. An additional consideration is that the limited participants with higher incomes may in turn skew the results of other questions. For example, we later ask “how willing are you to have affordable housing in your area”, there may be a difference in responses based on income. Housing affordability is more likely to affect lower-income individuals, thus this group is typically more inclined to support affordable housing.

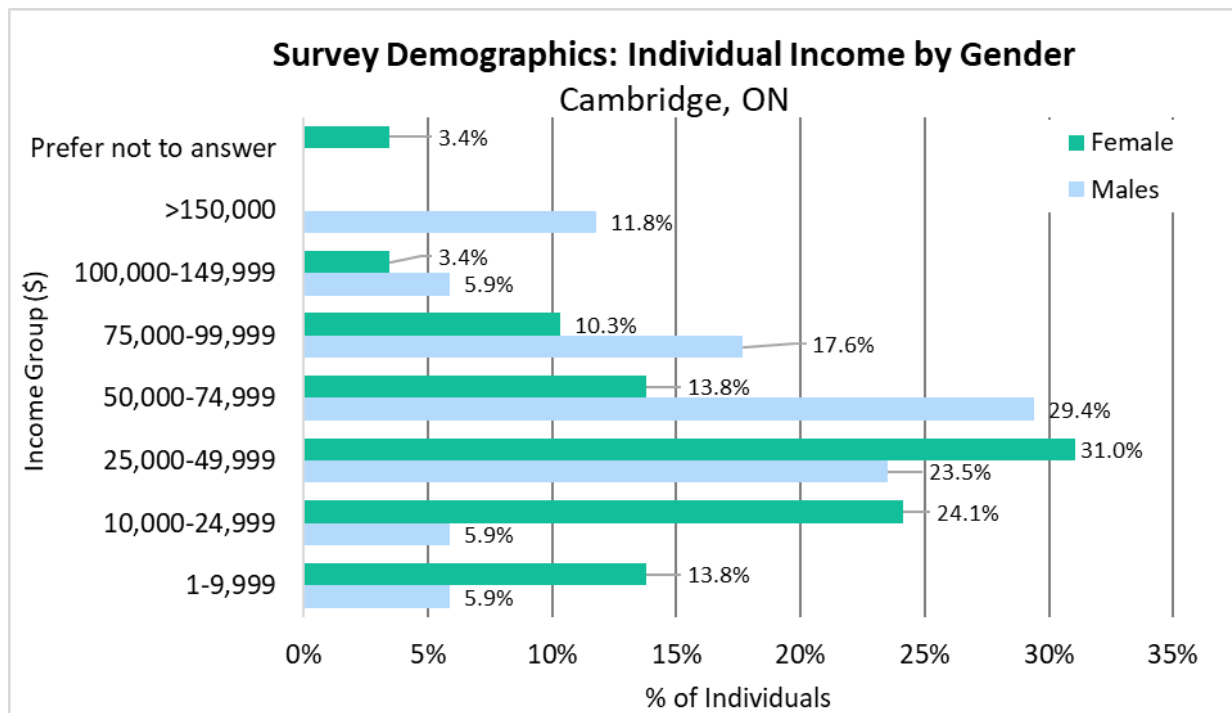


Figure 13: Survey individual income demographics

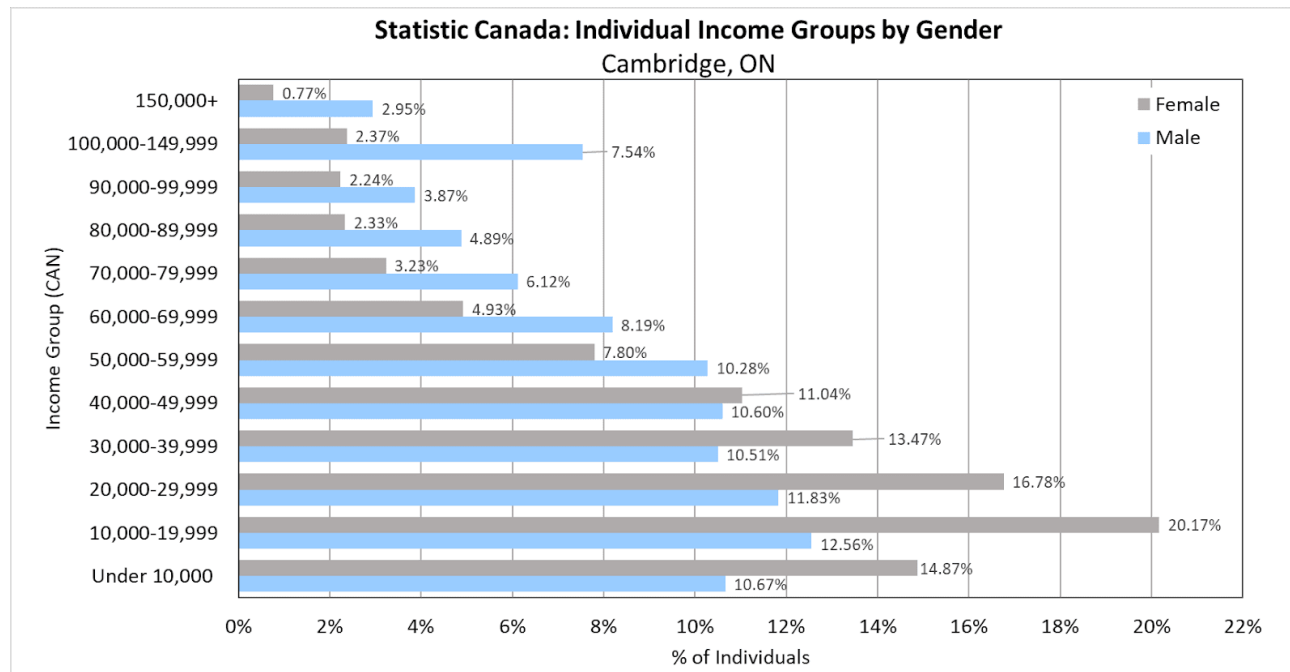


Figure 14: Cambridge population individual income demographics (Statistics Canada, 2017)

Comparing household incomes, our survey differs from the results of Statistics Canada since it depicts more income variation. Thus, when analyzing survey findings, readers must be mindful that this is not representative of the population's household income, and certain income brackets hold more influence on the survey results due to their increased representation.

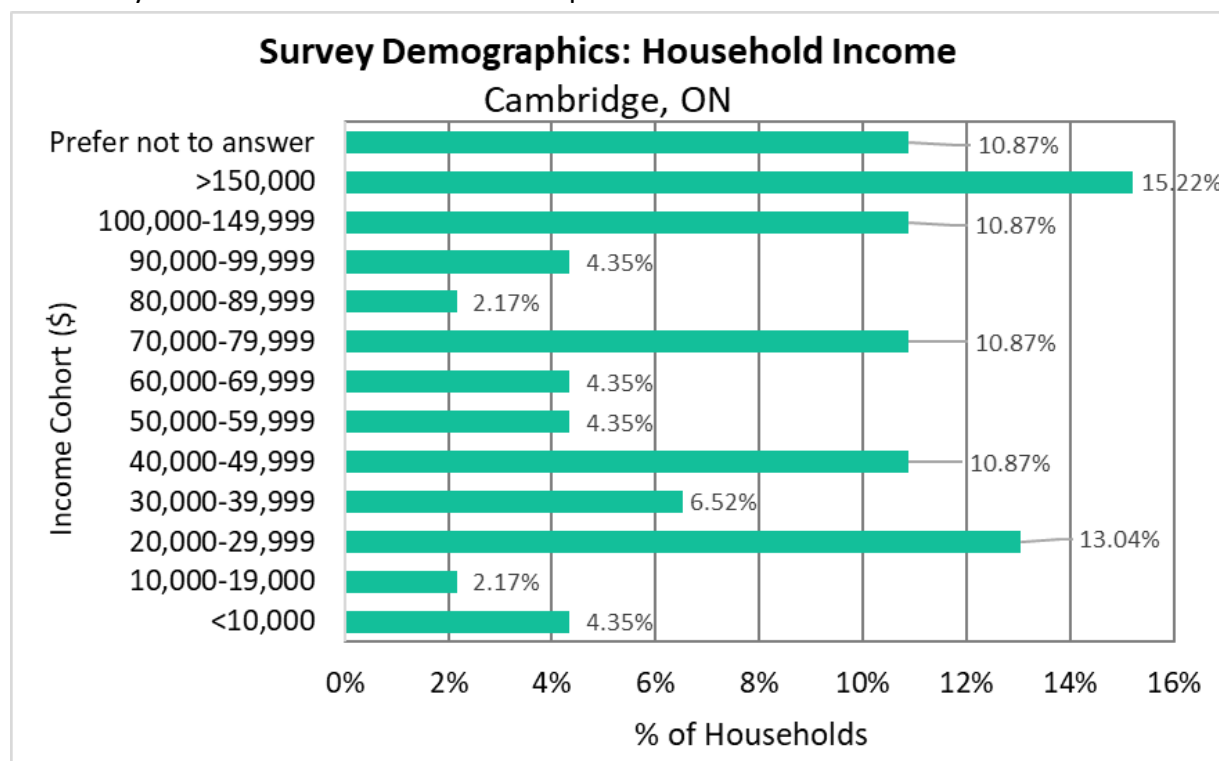


Figure 15: Survey household income demographics

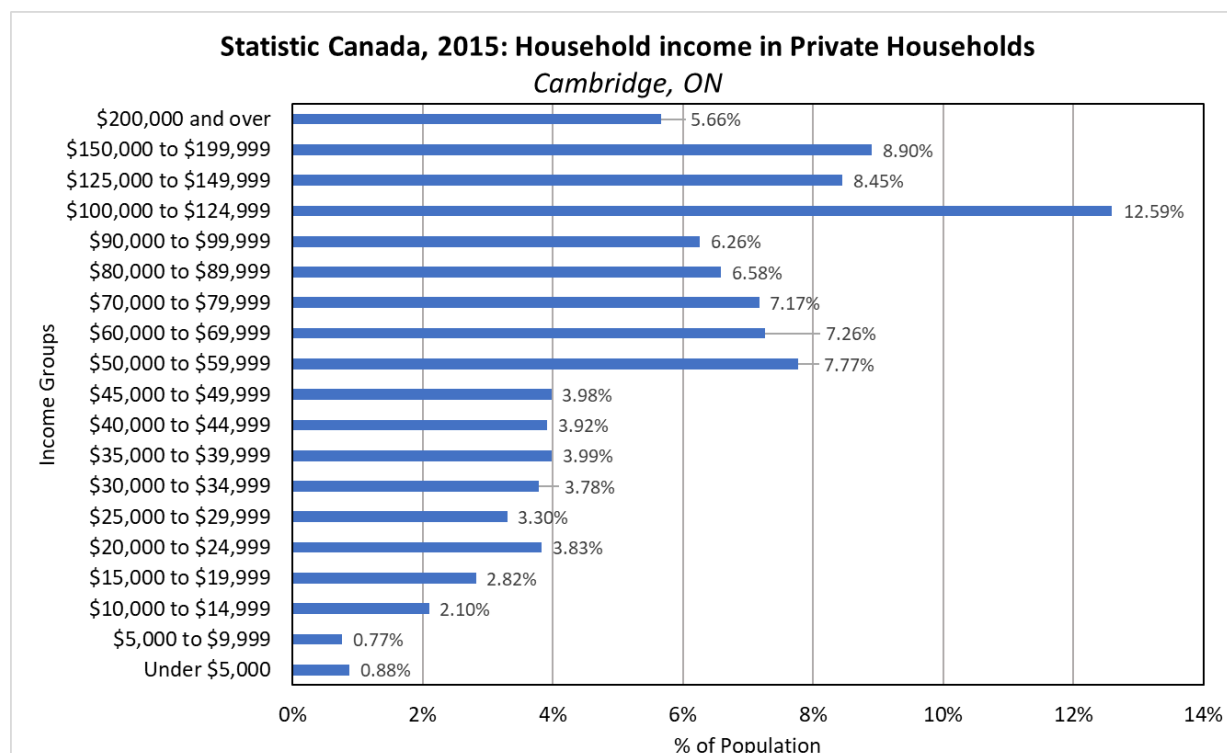


Figure 16: Cambridge population household demographics (Statistics Canada, 2017.)

## Key Findings

### Cambridge Characteristics

Table 7 demonstrates our survey's overall ranking of Cambridge characteristics on a scale of 1-5; 1 being terrible and 5 being excellent. Overall, participants ranked access to affordable housing as Cambridge's greatest weakness followed by walkability, public transportation and safety. Other categories obtained a score of 3 or higher, thus ranking them as average. From these results, we suggest the implementation of affordable housing to focus on high-density areas in order to reduce reliance on public transportation while increasing walkability.

Table 7: Participant ranking of Cambridge characteristics

|                    | Quality of Life | Access to Affordable Housing | Walkability | Public transportation | Appearance | Job opportunities | Safety | Parking availability |
|--------------------|-----------------|------------------------------|-------------|-----------------------|------------|-------------------|--------|----------------------|
| Average            | 3.35            | 1.86                         | 2.71        | 2.77                  | 3.06       | 3.17              | 2.95   | 3.39                 |
| Median             | 3.00            | 2.00                         | 3.00        | 3.00                  | 3.00       | 3.00              | 3.00   | 3.00                 |
| Standard Deviation | 0.81            | 0.90                         | 0.92        | 0.90                  | 0.87       | 0.90              | 0.98   | 0.96                 |
| Mode               | 3.00            | 1.00                         | 3.00        | 3.00                  | 3.00       | 3.00              | 3.00   | 3.00                 |

## Concerns

Table 8 depicts concerns participants stated for both social and affordable housing. The most commonly mentioned concerns for both types of housing, excluding “no concerns” responses, are drug increase and crime and safety concerns. Notably, these concerns are more prominent in responses targeted towards social housing. However, these concerns are built upon misconceptions or incomplete understandings which are addressed in the next section. Other concerns include implementation, location, disturbances, and aesthetics. These concerns are addressed throughout our case study analysis.

*Table 8: Participant concerns with social and affordable housing*

| Concerns                               | Social Housing Responses Count | Affordable Housing Responses Count |
|----------------------------------------|--------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| No concerns                            | 26 (49.1%)                     | 37 (69.8%)                         |
| Drug increase                          | 7 (13.2%)                      | 3 (5.7%)                           |
| Crime and safety concerns              | 8 (15.1%)                      | 3 (5.7%)                           |
| Implementation of project              | 4 (7.5%)                       | 1 (1.9%)                           |
| Depreciation of current housing market | 2 (3.8%)                       | 0 (0.0%)                           |
| Location of project                    | 3 (5.7%)                       | 2 (3.8%)                           |
| Disturbance                            | 1 (1.9%)                       | 0 (0.0%)                           |
| Aesthetic                              | 1 (1.9%)                       | 3 (5.7%)                           |

## Addressing Crime and Safety Concerns

A study of 146 supportive housing units in Canada was unable to find statistically significant data that correlates the presence of supportive housing with increased crime. In fact, this study found that most social housing residents were present in the neighbourhood prior to the implementation of social housing (de Wolff, 2008). However, despite the residents not committing more crimes than individuals with higher incomes, they are arrested and held in custody (Novac, et al., 2006). Also, these residents have provided benefits to the area, such as supporting local businesses, strengthening local cohesion, and creation of local initiatives (de Wolff, 2008). Additionally, those experiencing housing insecurity tend to experience increased crime victimization, with young adults being the most vulnerable demographic. A study has found that among the sample of street youth, 76% reported at least one instance in the previous year and 72.8% report multiple instances of victimization. The reason for the increased victimization is due to weak support systems and their inability to take appropriate safety measures (Gaetz, et al., 2010). Another study has found they tend to be reluctant to report said crimes to police as they have experienced being excluded from police protection (Novac, et al., 2006). Overall, individuals experiencing housing insecurity do not commit more crime, but they are arrested more which contributes to their increased victimization and reluctance to seek help.

### Addressing Drug Concerns

In Canada, the most cited reason for housing loss is addiction or substance use, contributing about 25.1% of housing loss (Government of Canada, 2021). The relationship between drug use and homelessness is complex, while these rates are disproportionately high this alone does not signal a harmful lifestyle (Michael's House, n.d.). Addiction does not exist only in the homeless population, in fact it is estimated that approximately 21% of Canada's population will meet the addiction criteria in their lifetime (Canadian Mental Health Association, n.d.). Additionally, those experiencing housing insecurity are not the only group prone to substance use, in fact a study found that the demographic most prone to alcohol and marijuana use is young adults with higher socioeconomic status (Patrick, et al., 2012). This could be linked to why drug abuse is more common in homeless young adults. Another key consideration is many began forming alcohol dependency as children. In a New York City study, all participants began alcohol consumption as children. Out of this sample, 2/3 of them were children of alcoholics (Michael's House, n.d.). Therefore, while the issue of addiction and substance abuse is more prominent in homeless individuals, drug dependence tends to form before homelessness is the case, and addiction is a prevalent issue that is not limited to a sole demographic.

## **International Analysis: Supporting Tools for Missing Middle**

### ***Finding 1: Facilitate and Strengthen Private-Public Partnership Opportunities***

A partnership approach is essential to address the complexity of housing affordability. Both the private and the public sectors serve a key role in enforcing the implementation of affordable housing. The City will need a clear framework to find the balance and tradeoffs between the outcomes of regulation on the capability to supply affordable housing and different land uses (Theseira et al., 2020). Agreements between private and public sectors are necessary to ensure the success of the project at hand. This will also allow for the long-term supply of affordable housing. Therefore, the City will need to avoid strict regulations and produce collaborative focused initiatives. Ultimately, strong partnerships will reduce development risks, improve trust, participation, and collaboration (2020).

#### Best Practice

The best practices provided throughout this report focus on strengthening private-public partnership opportunities. This strategic direction guides the City to capitalize on partnerships and ensures that additional affordable housing options are made available for vulnerable groups. Effective partnerships must be built based on reciprocity, trust, and transparency to ensure their long-term success.

Summary of Key Factors to Success:

- Early and comprehensive preparation by both the public and private sectors
- Building trust as a core value
  - As it creates increase reciprocity
- Transparency to public and partners
  - Further builds trust

In the context of affordable housing, a public-private partnership includes collaboration between parties to achieve mutually benefitting goals. A mutually beneficial exchange can be a land or zoning contribution from the public sector and a servicing and building contribution from the private sector to increase affordable housing supply. According to the Smart Growth BC (SGBC) review of best practices in affordable housing, most of the jurisdictions they surveyed addressed the importance of these partnerships in providing affordable housing with allocated meeting minutes, specified language in their reports, and public comments (2014).

The variation between the types of partnerships and their purposes creates difficulty in providing quantification of this model; identifying one quantifiable model surrounding this strategy; moreover, in the case of ownership housing, the partners are only involved in the production. Thus, the City will need to address what would qualify as an appropriate contribution between all stakeholders. This could entail any significant public contribution to a project through grants, zoning, or low-cost land transfers (SGBC, 2014). A substantial challenge in the delivery of non-market housing is the absence of the risk and reward model that drives the delivery of market housing (2014). This challenge can be solved by building partnerships where integrated projects with market and non-market housing occur, and the private sector's interest is enhanced by the partnership but does not require profit from the nonmarket segment (2014). These partnerships can be found in 44% of the U.S., and 39% of the Canadian jurisdictions surveyed by SGBC (2014).

#### [The Wellington Neighbourhood - Breckenridge Colorado](#)

In the *Urban Land Institute* "Ten Principles for Successful Public/Private Partnerships", building trust as a core value was recognized from beginning to end in successful partnerships. Trust can be earned through work and commitment to a project. Maintaining trust is reinforced through each partner's realization of the expected responsibilities and mutual goals (Corrigan et al., 2005). However, the City should be cautious of partners overpromising to secure support as this could lead to a lack of completion and incredulity.

The Wellington Neighbourhood demonstrates the necessity of trust in building successful private-public partnerships. In this example, trust emerged from the realization of agreed-upon project objectives including open space preservation, community development, alternative transportation opportunities, and affordable housing. This resulted in 80% of the 122 housing units' development being deed-restricted affordable for low and middle-income local workers (2005). Housing types ranged from single, detached units to two-unit residences (2005). Trust was maintained throughout the four-year development process because of the honest, transparent and cooperative nature between local developers, and public

authorities (2005). Furthermore, to increase feasibility, the public sector implemented regulatory incentives, such as impact fee waivers, and adopted deed restrictions that require owners to work a minimum number of hours per week in Summit County (2005). They also placed a cap on the amount of appreciation per year to maintain affordability (2005). Additionally, extensive public involvement was used to obtain community support in the authorization of rezoning the site for higher-density development (2005). Articulated by developer David O'Neil:

*"Trust was important because there were no upfront guarantees. Trust allowed each party to take a risk that they would not otherwise have taken. Without trust, the parties would not have taken the risk, and nothing would have happened." (2005).*

## Geelong, Australia

The City of Greater Geelong found itself in a unique opportunity where private-public partnerships could lead to the success of solving their social housing crisis. Housing poverty, homelessness and their impacts on individuals and families can lead to physical and mental health crises. The City identified these challenges in the community, but they are not the level of government responsible for delivering social housing, nor do they have the necessary resources to address current and future social housing needs (City of Greater Geelong, 2020). Thus, the City negotiated partnership arrangements between the State and Commonwealth Governments to implement any plan attaining social housing targets (2020). Key issues identified by the City that directly impact the effectiveness of a Social Housing Plan include the scale of investment, mechanisms available in reducing costs, and the subsidy required to meet targets for social housing (2020).

The population of Geelong is expected to grow by at least another 50,000 dwellings over the next two decades, and currently, there is a shortage of 7,200 social housing dwellings, and 50% of the existing social housing needing to be replaced over the time period (2020). Any Social Housing Plan designed to overcome homelessness and housing poverty is estimated to need 13,500 new social housing dwellings by 2041 (2020). In order to achieve a successful Social Housing Plan, the City is advised to:

1. Take a leadership role in advocating for an increase in social housing by presenting compelling data and a coherent strategy to both the State and Commonwealth government.
2. Invest in social housing by contributing suitable sites surplus to the City requirements and a modest annual budget thereby demonstrating its commitment and credibility.
3. Develop partnerships with both the state and commonwealth government culminating in funding agreements that will lead to significant growth in social housing over the next 20 years
4. Amend the planning scheme in the context of recent amendments to the Victorian Planning & Environment Act and the anticipated outcomes of the new Victorian Ministerial Advisory Committee on the role of planning legislation to support social housing to enable Council to negotiate significant developer contributions to social housing.



5. Participate in ongoing Urban renewal plans for Corio, Norlane and Whittington thereby contributing to increased social, environmental, and economic sustainability in these three very disadvantaged suburbs.
6. Build capacity in the local infrastructure necessary to achieve the social housing growth and regeneration objective by building key operational infrastructure organizations.

*Source: City of Greater Geelong, 2020*

Thus, the five key factors in ensuring the success of any Social Housing Plan from 2020-2041, the City of Greater Geelong must focus on 1) Leadership 2) Investment 3) Partnerships 4) Planning 5) Urban Revitalization and 5) Capacity Building.

Partners that will aid in the successful implementation of supplying social housing includes registered housing agencies, registered housing associations, registered housing providers, and private developers (2020). Therefore, to successfully increase social housing supply with the help of partnerships the City of Geelong was advised to:

- a. Establish collaborative partnerships with the Department of Health and Human Services
- b. Ensure that a Registered Housing Association (RHAs) commits to growing social housing in Geelong
- c. Exercise greater control over agreements between RHAs and developers
- d. Provide a more planned, orderly, and coordinated approach to the development of social housing

*Source: City of Greater Geelong, 2020*

### Lessons Learned:

The case studies for our first finding “Facilitate and Strengthen Private-Public Partnership Opportunities” shows the power private-public partnerships hold as a tool. Municipalities can work within a partnership framework to maximize affordable housing opportunities. It is ideal for the City to work with pre-existing partnerships because trust is already established thus increasing reciprocity. Utilizing partnerships should be a top priority, and parties will need to establish realistic targets and timeframes for any undertaking of a project. Ultimately the lessons that the City of Cambridge can take away from these cases are to allocate the appropriate amount of time in building capacity with stakeholders (SGBC report), follow the principles of building successful private-public partnerships (The Wellington Neighbourhood), and implement well thought out models in using partnerships as a tool in addressing affordable housing (Geelong).

## ***Finding 2: Usage of Regulatory Tools to Encourage a Diverse Mix of Housing***

To address affordable housing, the most effective tool that the City has the authority to use within the legislation is inclusionary zoning. Under the zoning bylaw, inclusionary zoning is a regulatory tool used to ensure affordable housing units are supplied in new residential development. It addresses the missing middle with long-term land use planning and ensures a diverse mix of housing development is underway.

Best Practice: Inclusionary Zoning

Inclusionary zoning policies from Richmond California, Boulder Colorado, Chapel Hill, North Carolina, and Sydney Australia have been reviewed to provide valuable insight on the options available to Cambridge.

Summary of Key Factors to Success:

- Build strong partnerships
- Ease on zoning and development costs
- Appropriate incentives and set aside rates

The S.W.O.T. analysis shown in Table 9 for inclusionary zoning identifies the strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and threats based on the case studies below. The primary strength is that there is less direct government spending. There is also more flexibility, meaning that the City can choose how they wish to meet their affordability targets. As for the developers, the incentives offered will encourage them to build in Cambridge, but only with strong partnerships will this be enough. Poor incentives are able to drive developers out of Cambridge, thus the City will need to use partnerships as a tool in creating appropriate incentives for developers. These partnerships will also address the listed weaknesses, such as establishing market needs and unit types for vulnerable groups. To ensure that the prices below market rates are actually affordable for vulnerable groups, we would recommend using several median income averages across different sections of Cambridge. Finally, as to ensure proper management of the units, we suggest exploring alternative management initiatives which is illustrated in the Chapel Hill case study. With all things considered, the City should be weary of zoning restrictions, and council disapproval as threats. Thus, we recommend that the City eases zoning jurisdictions.

*Table 9: S.W.O.T. Analysis of Inclusionary Zoning*

| S.W.O.T. Section     | Analysis                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Strengths</b>     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Incentivizes developers to build</li> <li>• Flexibility in addressing targets</li> <li>• Encourages mixed neighbourhoods</li> <li>• Less direct government spending</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>Weaknesses</b>    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• What constitutes as affordable is not always the same</li> <li>• Costs and incentives may not be enough for developers</li> <li>• Cohesion between market needs and unit types</li> <li>• Improper management of units</li> </ul>                                                                              |
| <b>Opportunities</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Partnerships</li> <li>• Different set aside rates and thresholds</li> <li>• Set aside rates based on level of income</li> <li>• Affordability based on median income averages</li> <li>• Mandatory inclusionary zoning</li> <li>• Alternative management of units to ensure compliance with the law</li> </ul> |
| <b>Threats</b>       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Zoning red tapes</li> <li>• Council disapproval</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |

## Richmond, California

In the case of Richmond California, the City acknowledged that inclusionary zoning was the most important strategic direction in addressing affordable housing (City of Richmond, 2019). The goal of the City was to encourage a diverse mix of housing types and tenures (2019). The set aside rates for inclusionary zoning is divided in three categories. For units that are affordable to people living on moderate incomes the rate is 17% or more, for people living on low incomes the rate is 15% or more, and for people on very low incomes it is 10% or more (Meagher, 2019). Several California jurisdictions also vary the set aside rates based on the depth of affordability. In fact, a study of inclusionary zoning programs in the U.S. shows that 35% of programs identified used set aside rates that varied according to level of affordability, project size, tenure, and geographic location (2019). Ultimately, this addresses one of the weaknesses with inclusionary zoning which is ensuring that the units are actually affordable for those living in them. To ensure affordability in the long term, the City implemented resale controls on ownership units, this includes:

- A. The resale price of an inclusionary unit shall be in the amount equal to the price affordable to a very low, low, or moderate-income household, as adjusted from time to time based on the consumer price index for Contra Costa County. For example, if the unit was originally sold to a low-income household, the unit must be resold to another low-income household.
- B. Inclusionary units offered for sale pursuant to this Article by the original purchaser and all subsequent purchasers shall be offered for sale first to the City of Richmond or its designee.
- C. For the first resale of an inclusionary unit during the 30-year term of the agreement, the unit may be sold as a market-rate unit provided the difference between the inclusionary unit and the market-rate unit price is deposited in the City's affordable housing fund. A purchaser of an inclusionary unit who pays a market-rate price shall not be subject to the provisions of this section.

*Source: City of Richmond, 2019*

## Economic Breakdown: Richmond, USA

Major stand outs with Richmond's age demographics are that the city has a very well-balanced age pyramid, that reflects the aging population pyramid type, as seen in Figure 17. However, one of the largest groups is 0-9 years with 14.90% falling under this category (Census Reporter, 2019). Though, the combined groups of 30-49 comprise 31.49%, whereas the same groups for Cambridge make up 27.50%. Overall, these two cities have similar age pyramids which reflect in the other demographic comparisons.

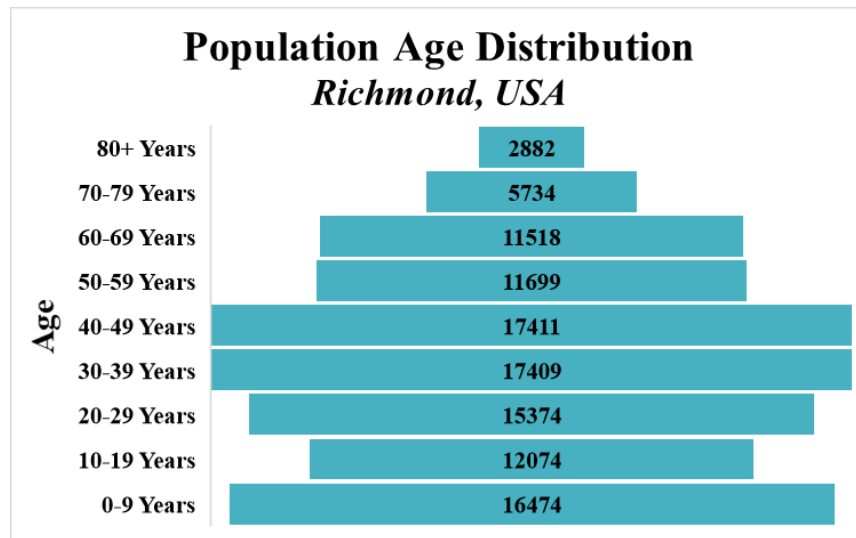


Figure 17: Population Age Distribution graph for Richmond, USA

Next, Richmond is very similar to Los Angeles in terms of education, as there are many people without an educational degree or diploma (23.70%), which is much higher than Cambridge's 15.46%. However, more people have received either a postgraduate degree or a bachelor's degree (31%) in Richmond compared to Cambridge (10.86%) (Census Reporter, 2019).

The city of Richmond has a balance between people making low and medium annual incomes. For low incomes, the category 'Under \$63,445' comprises 32% of the population, whereas \$63,445 to \$126,890 has 33.90% (Census Reporter, 2019). Overall, these rates are very similar to Cambridge, as shown in Figure 18.

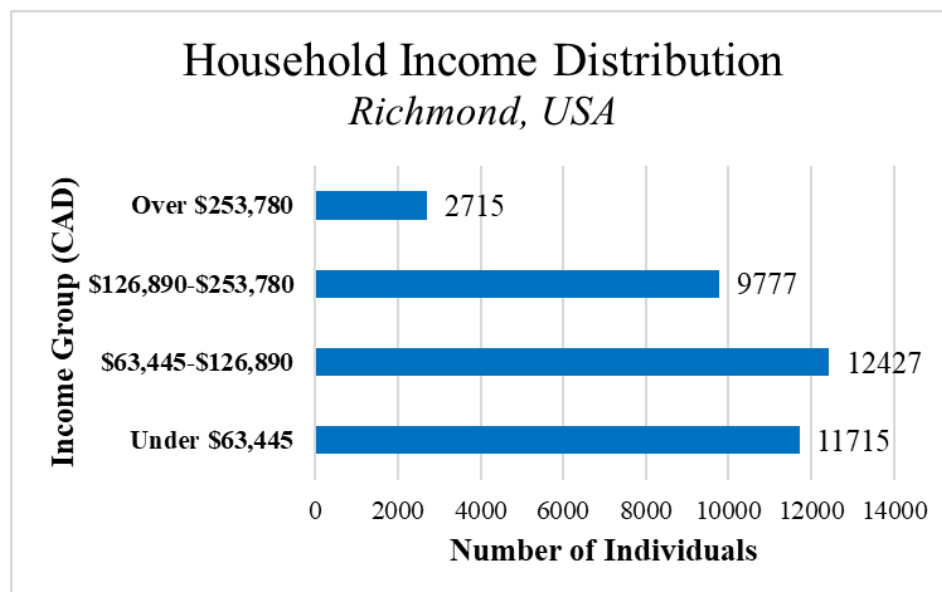


Figure 18: Bar graph showing the household income distribution in Richmond, California, converted to CAD (Census Reporter, 2019).

Also similar to Los Angeles, the majority of the population is Hispanic, with 48.10% people reporting this as their ethnicity (Census Reporter, 2019). Interestingly, differently from Cambridge, only 16.10% are White in Richmond, while 17.70% identify as Black and 12.60% as Asian descent (Census Reporter, 2019). Indeed, Richmond occupies a much different ethnic background than Cambridge does. However, ethnicity is not a deciding factor in whether Richmond's affordable housing solutions worked or not, as there are many other key characteristics, such as household income, which was identified as very similar to Cambridge.

## Boulder, Colorado

In Boulder Colorado, the *Expanding Affordable Housing Options* program requires all new residential development to contribute 25% of the total units as permanently affordable housing (City of Boulder, 2021). Set aside rates vary from city to city, however larger cities like Boulder, Colorado usually require a set aside rate of at least 20% (Meagher, 2019).

In an extensive review of US programs conducted in 2017, the set aside rates averaged between 10%-20% (2019). Set aside rates can be calculated as a percentage of the units in development or as a percentage of gross floor area (2019). It is important to note that rates also change over time, and some jurisdictions start with low rates and then gradually raise them (2019). Inclusionary zoning programs do not apply to all developments, and it is the jurisdiction that will often set a minimum size for a development to be included in its inclusionary zoning, this is called the threshold (2019).

In Boulder, Colorado, the threshold is set very low, with a minimum development size of one unit of housing (2019). Conversely, the majority of inclusionary zoning programs surveyed in studies ranging from 2010 and 2017 had a minimum requirement of 10 units or less, and no programs were found that had thresholds over 50 units (2019). Since fee-in-lieu options are prohibited under the Ontario inclusionary zoning legislation, the range of options for meeting inclusionary zoning obligations is more restricted than it is in other jurisdictions (2019). Either complete housing units must be provided (making a 10% set aside impossible to achieve for development under 10 units), or a credit transfer option should be used, or a land dedication at the value of the required contribution (2019).

### Economic Breakdown: Boulder, USA

The city of Boulder also has a younger population, as their highest age group is 20-29 years, comprising 30.09% of their population. Likewise, their second highest age group is 10-19 years, containing 17.20% (Census Reporter, 2019). Of course, this differs greatly from Cambridge who has a much older population.

There are many elementary and high schools in the city, as well as the University of Denver which is less than an hour away and the University of Colorado campus located in the city. Thus, many people have a postgraduate degree (40.60%) or a bachelor's degree (38.20%) (Census Reporter, 2019). Combined, these numbers equal almost 80% of the Boulder population. As mentioned, compared to Boulder, the citizens in Cambridge have less of an educational background overall.

Looking at household income, since the population is mostly young adults and students, the highest category of income groups is under \$63,445 CAD (36%) (Census Reporter, 2019). Therefore, many of these people are students. However, affordable housing is still important for many people in this income bracket, as these households are receiving a low amount of income. There is also a mix of people in the other groups, which is shown in Figure 19.

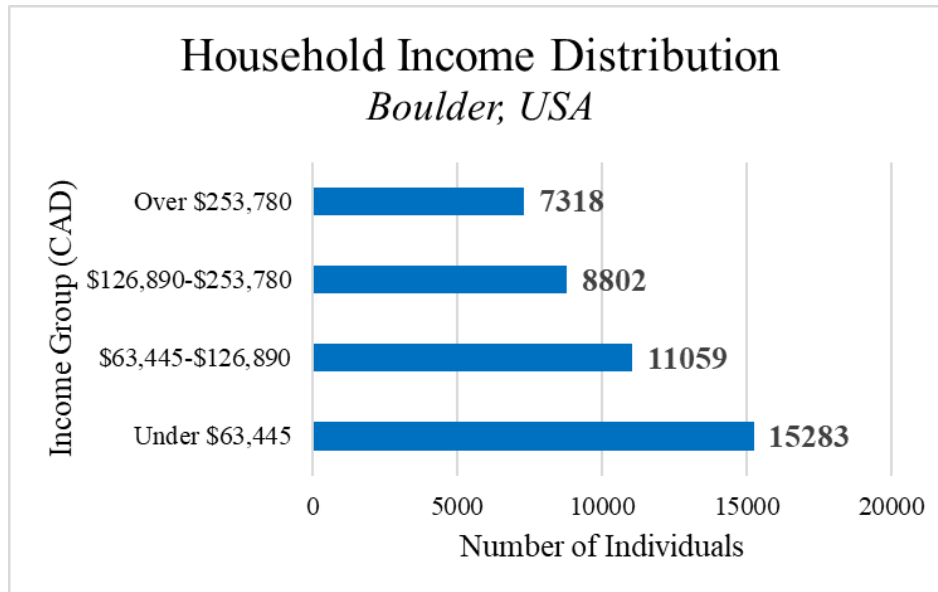


Figure 19: Bar graph showing the household income distribution in Boulder, converted to CAD, (Census Reporter, 2019).

Finally, 80% of the population in Boulder are White, making it the large majority (Census Reporter, 2019). The second highest group are Hispanic people. Like Cambridge, White people make the majority, but similar to the ethnic demographics of Chapel Hill, a comparison is not very accurate, as the ethnic group categories are different between the two cities (Census Reporter, 2019).

### Chapel Hill, North Carolina

As previously mentioned, appropriate management can be a major concern that comes with inclusionary zoning. In the case of Chapel Hill, North Carolina, the City has chosen to transfer management of units and of compliance obligations in whole or in part to non-profit organizations dedicated to the provisions of affordable housing (2019). This option ensures the operators run the units in compliance with the law and in doing so eliminates the possibility of facing substantial economic and logistical burdens (2019). Thus, moving the management to non-profit housing groups can increase the overall effectiveness and performance of this recommendation. If the City chooses not to follow this model, another option could be transferring the housing to the municipality, either as finished units or land dedications (2019). This option ensures better management, as well as offering a wider range of affordable housing options. Ultimately, the City has better control on supporting the most vulnerable groups.

### Economic Breakdown: Chapel Hill, USA

There are very few similarities between Chapel Hill's age distribution and Cambridge. Notably, there is a large university, known as the University of North Carolina, which signifies the reason the city has a much younger population. A total of 28.75% of the population falls between the age of 20-29, whereas the same group only contains 12.52% of Cambridge's population. The main difference is that these younger individuals will be looking for new housing or apartments in Chapel Hill and as many are students, they are making less money than the older population would. Household income for the city will be discussed below.

Chapel Hill is a very educated city with 96% of residents receiving at least a high school diploma. Also, 48.20% of citizens have a postgraduate degree, while 28.80% have a bachelor's degree. Only 4% of people do not have a degree, which is just over 1000 people, as the population is only approximately 61,000 in Chapel Hill.

However, as mentioned, due to the high number of younger adults and students in Chapel Hill, looking at Figure 20, 39.10% of individuals make less than \$63,445 in household income a year. Despite the high rate of low income in Chapel Hill, 18.60% of citizens make over \$253,780 a year, which correlates to the very high education levels.

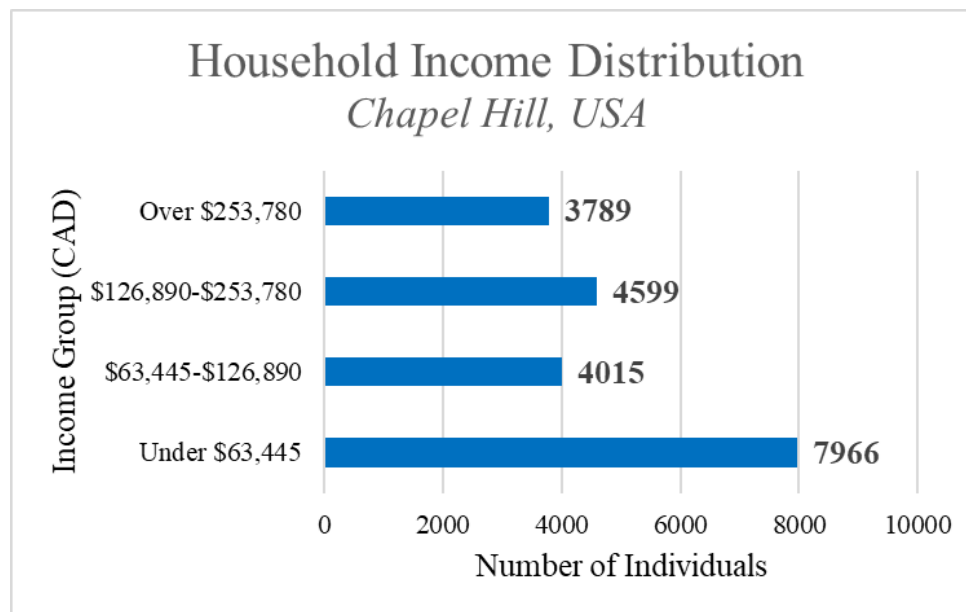


Figure 20: Bar graph showing the household income distribution in Chapel Hill, converted to CAD (Census Reporter, 2019).

Lastly, the ethnic origins of the people in Chapel Hill are relative to those in Cambridge, as most of the population is White. Specifically, two thirds identify as White, while 13% identify as Asian, and 11% are Black (Census Reporter, 2019).



## Sydney, Australia

In order to increase the overall effectiveness of inclusionary zoning, there are several models that suggest mandatory inclusionary zoning as the better alternative. Mandatory inclusionary zoning would require that all development projects adhere to the zoning policies, rather than on a voluntary basis. This is similar to what was done in Boulder Colorado as it implies any development with at least one unit must adhere to the inclusionary zoning policies. Sydney, Australia has created a promising model of mandatory inclusionary zoning. Ultimately, this model follows some of the mentioned strategies as explained in the other case studies. These strategies were also shared in the N. Barry Lyon Consultants Limited (NBLC) report for inclusionary zoning conducted for the City of Cambridge. The model suggests beginning the policy with a 10% set aside rate, which is relatively small, but to implement gradual increments along with annual re-assessments as to target the City's most current needs (The Constellation Project, 2020). Here is how mandatory inclusionary zoning is being proposed in Sydney Australia:

1. In metropolitan areas of Australia at least 10% of all housing floor space developed on privately owned land should be designated, in perpetuity, as social or affordable rental housing, under CHP management.
2. Higher targets should be set for market housing development on public land.
3. Registered CHPs should apply to an appropriate State Agency to be the recipient of MIZ housing in a particular local government area.
4. Local Housing Strategies must be prepared by councils within 12 months of the legislation being enacted and updated every five years to advise CHPs on the mix of MIZ-generated affordable housing in terms of social versus affordable rental status (but that each should never be less than 20% - i.e., if social is 20%, affordable is 80%, and vice versa).
5. To allow the market to adjust to this new legislation there should be: (a). a "notice period" of two years after the legislation is enacted; and (b). a "transition period" for the four years after the notice period, during which the MIZ obligation should be 5%.
6. From 12 years after the inception of the legislation CHPs should be allowed to trade and transfer their MIZ between each other.
7. MIZ should apply to all developments that create more than one additional dwelling. The MIZ requirement should be a stated condition of the Development Approval (DA) consent, and the housing should be dedicated when the subdivision plan (Torrens or strata) is registered. Where the development creates less than ten dwellings a cash payment should be made to the appropriate State Agency. These funds should be pooled for construction or purchase of social and affordable rental housing.

*Source: The Constellation Project, 2020*

### Lessons Learned:

The case studies for inclusionary zoning showcases several options in the implementation and methodology of inclusionary zoning. It is important for the City to further investigate the potential weaknesses of inclusionary zoning in Cambridge specifically. Once the biggest threats or weaknesses are identified, the City can look at the best practice above for ways in overcoming those challenges. For example, addressing affordability over the long term (Richmond), addressing thresholds (Boulder), management of units (Chapel Hill), overall effectiveness and alternative models (Sydney).

Looking deeper at set aside rates, as shown in Figure 21, due to the specific socio-economic realities of Cambridge, we would advise setting the rate anywhere between 10% to 15% depending on the City's specific affordability targets. We suggest a 15% set aside rate if the City chooses to conduct an aggressive approach, or if the City wishes to ease into inclusionary zoning, we suggest a 10% rate. We also advise annual re-assessments and gradual increments of set aside rates to the final inclusionary zoning policy. It is important to note that strengthening partnerships, easing zoning and development costs, and making appropriate incentives are all essential in the success of this recommendation.

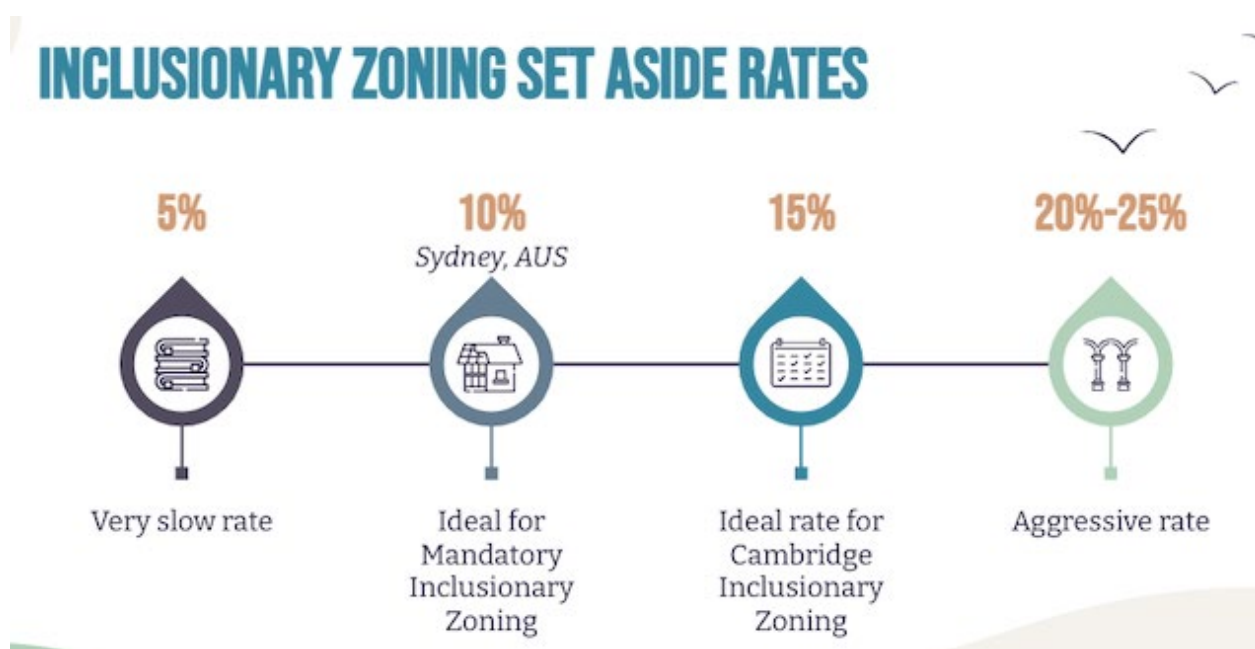


Figure 21: Inclusionary zoning set aside rates and applicability to Cambridge

### Economic Breakdown: Greater Sydney, Australia

The demographics for Sydney, Australia apply to the entire Greater Sydney region, as inclusionary zoning recommendations have occurred throughout the region.

The Greater Sydney area population has a well-balanced age distribution, which is similar to that of Cambridge, Ontario. The largest category for age is between 30-39, which contains 15.51% of the

population (Australian Bureau of Statistics, 2016). In fact, the percentage of people in this category is very close to Cambridge, which has 13.12% of people in this age group. Also, the older age groups are very similar with groups ages 70-79 and 80+ being within 0.20% of those for Cambridge. The only real difference between Greater Sydney, Australia and Cambridge, Ontario is the amount of people between the two cities. Specifically, the total population of the Greater Sydney area is almost 5 million people as of 2016 (Australian Bureau of Statistics, 2016), compared to 130,000 for Cambridge (Statistics Canada, 2017).

Australia has a different educational framework than Canada does. However, the data is still useful to conduct an educational comparison between the two locations. Firstly, almost 20% more of the population has a bachelor's degree or above in Greater Sydney than Cambridge. There are also approximately 9% fewer people who have not received any degree of education in Greater Sydney. However, the number of people who have only obtained year 12 or below, which is equivalent to high school in Cambridge, is significantly higher, falling at 38% of the Greater Sydney area population, compared to 22.88% in Cambridge.

Similar to differences in education, Australia reported household income differently than in Canada. The pie chart is shown in Figure 22. Unlike Canada and the United States, Australia uses two categories which are low- and high-income groups. Importantly, these values were converted to CAD, for an easier comparison to the data Cambridge provided in their 2016 census. Looking at Figure 22, people who receive less than \$604 CAD gross weekly income make up 16.80% of the population, whereas those who receive more than \$2790 CAD gross weekly income equal 23.80% (Australian Bureau of Statistics, 2016). Comparably, the lower bracket is similar to those who receive less than \$30,000 annually in Canada, whereas the higher bracket is approximately those who earn above \$100,000 annually.

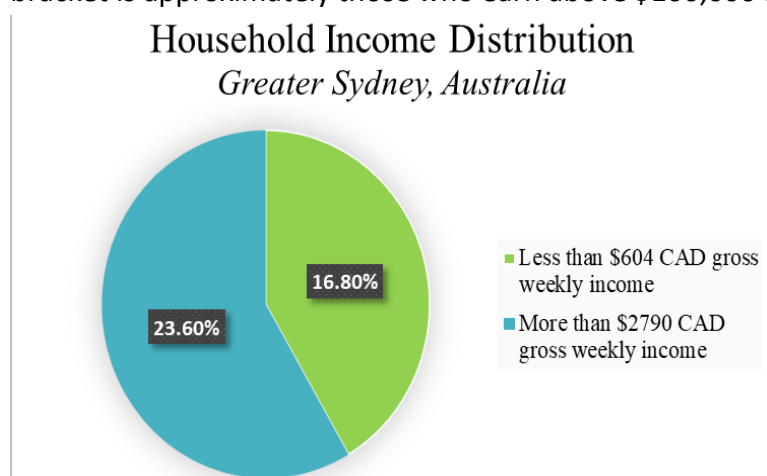


Figure 22: Pie chart showing Household Income Distribution between low and high annual incomes for Greater Sydney, Australia (Australian Bureau of Statistics, 2016).

Additionally, when observing ethnic origins, Australia's census data reports country of origin, which makes it difficult to conduct a proper comparative analysis between Greater Sydney and Cambridge. Regardless, Greater Sydney is a very diverse city and welcomes people with many different backgrounds. Even though

most of the population is from Australia, Figure 23 shows that many people have immigrated from other locations to the city. Also, like Cambridge, the majority of the population is White. However, there is an insufficient amount of correlative data to compare the two cities regarding ethnic origins (Australian Bureau of Statistics, 2016).

### Population Country of Birth Greater Sydney, Australia

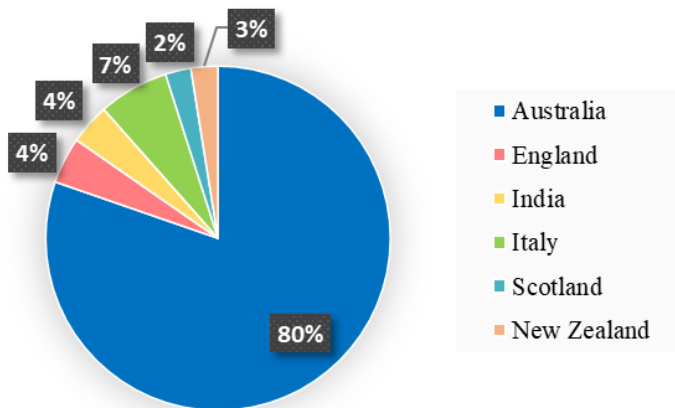


Figure 23: Population country of birth in Greater Sydney, Australia (Australian Bureau of Statistics, 2016).

### Finding 3: Revitalization Projects

As mentioned, partnerships are key in building long lasting affordable housing solutions, and revitalization projects are no exception. Revitalization is meant to re-purpose or improve upon pre-existing and unused areas in pursuit of creating mixed housing types and affordable housing. Thus, inherently addressing the missing middle problem. The best practice research indicates that vacant properties that are already zoned for multifamily development would be optimal for this recommendation. This is because it can speed up the process of providing affordable or social housing by bypassing zoning laws. However, this is not always going to be feasible, thus, we have compiled a few alternative options for this strategy.

#### Best Practice: Revitalization

The following is an analysis of our best practice research for social and affordable housing revitalization projects. The goal is to provide examples of revitalization projects which have proven effective in other jurisdictions, explain the tools and funding methods to support it, and identify the key success factors.

#### Summary of Key Factors to Success:

- Strong Partnerships
- Ease on zoning and development costs
- Identify funding opportunities
- Supplementary programs

The S.W.O.T. analysis shown in Table 10 for revitalization projects identifies the strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and threats based on the case studies below. The primary strength is the several grant programs available to the City that acts as an incentive. Revitalization also compliments the targets identified in the Cambridge Official Plan, for example, focusing on intensification in the node areas. Clear revitalization definitions and objectives are also necessary to avoid the possibility of gentrification. This recommendation is feasible because of the older infrastructure in Cambridge. To ensure success of this recommendation we advise the City to consider the alternative projects identified in the case studies, along with any one or combination of our supplementary programs identified later in this report. All things considered the City will need to apply for funding opportunities, be forgiving of zoning policies, and ease on development costs as to avoid any threats that come along with this recommendation.

Table 10: S.W.O.T. Analysis of Revitalization

| S.W.O.T. Section     | Analysis                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Strengths</b>     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Financial incentives</li> <li>Maximizes the use of existing infrastructure</li> <li>Reduces urban sprawl</li> </ul>                                                                         |
| <b>Weaknesses</b>    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Direct government costs</li> <li>Costs can vary and become expensive</li> <li>Without clear definitions and objectives, gentrification may occur</li> </ul>                                 |
| <b>Opportunities</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Presents opportunities in alternative housing projects (Container homes)</li> <li>Build capacity with partners</li> <li>Usage of supplementary program to increase affordability</li> </ul> |
| <b>Threats</b>       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Zoning red tapes</li> <li>Council disapproval</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                    |

## Bristol, United Kingdom

In Bristol, there have been several initiatives focused on supplying affordable housing in unique ways. The first example is the site of a former primary school which was used to build 161 homes (Cork, 2018). These homes had various housing types such as ownership/market price, rental, and affordable housing (2018). This helps to reduce the missing middle problem and encourages mixed-use housing in the same neighbourhood. The key partnerships involved in ensuring the success of this solution was with a housing association, community investment company and private investors (2018). This model sold some houses at market price and others were available through tenures, which includes shared-ownership and rent to buy options (2018). This model focused on aiding the vital workers in the city that were being priced out (2018). Cambridge has a growing population and lots of its residents are being priced out by foreign investment, and commuters. This scheme could aid vulnerable groups in need of social housing.

This is only one example of the success revitalizing has to offer in the Bristol communities. Another unique project Bristol undertook was to build homes using shipping containers. This follows a similar framework as the tiny home movement. However, instead of building a home with traditional materials, recycled shipping containers are used instead. Although there are several models and ways to do this, Bristol had a unique example of providing housing for the student population with a project called LaunchPad (Bristol SU Lettings, 2022). The project turned shipping containers into comfortable and modern homes for students to live in. This solution provides an inexpensive and creative solution to supplying affordable housing units. In the LaunchPad project, shipping containers were stacked up 3-storeys tall in an apartment-like structure. This example proves to bypass certain constraints, such as purchasing the land. In this case, the land was leased and with the structure's innovative design, once the lease is done, the units can easily be removed with a trailer. It is important to note that this project was not able to be done without the strong partnerships involved (2022).

#### Economic Breakdown: Bristol, United Kingdom

The 2016 census that was found for Bristol, UK groups their age categories into larger categories. Despite this, Bristol shares a similar age range as Cambridge. Specifically, the biggest group for Bristol is ages 45-64, which holds 31.74% of the population. Relatedly, Cambridge's 40-59 age group has 29.33% of the population, which is very alike. Thus, in terms of age distribution, it is easy to compare the two cities, despite these locations being very far from one another.

Next, education is formatted very differently in Bristol than in Cambridge, which is shown in Figure 24. Briefly, in terms of an educational breakdown, the highest level of education possible has 32.78% of individuals in Bristol, whereas those who have no qualifications are only 4.92%.

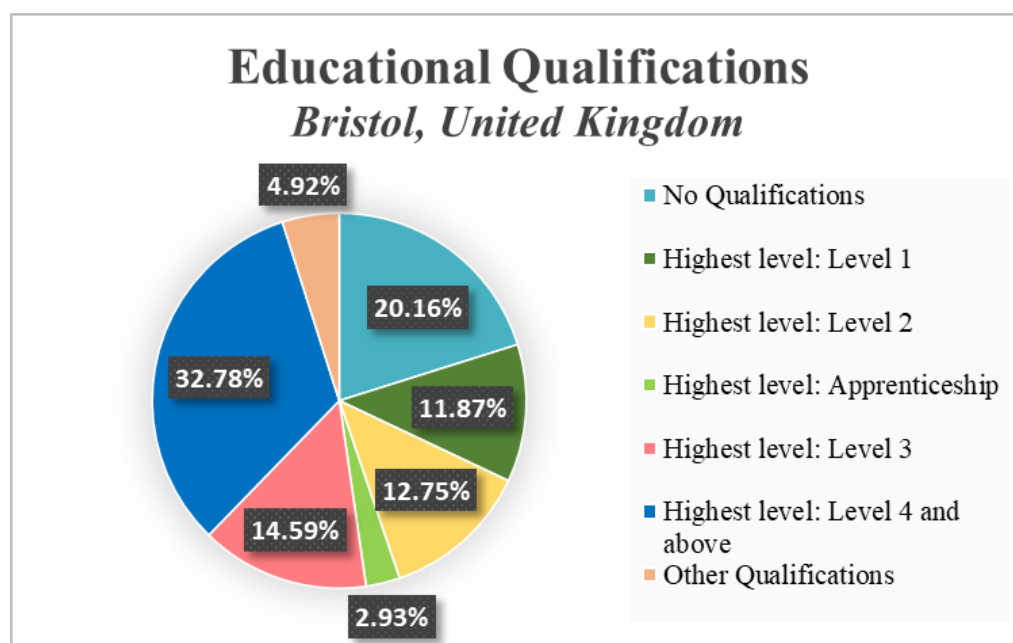


Figure 24: Pie graph showing the educational qualifications for Bristol, United Kingdom



There is no data recorded for household income in Bristol, UK.

However, in terms of ethnic backgrounds, most citizens are White, which is similar when compared to Cambridge, Ontario. There is also 6.01% of the population being Black and 5.52% Asian (Office for National Statistics, 2016).

### Los Angeles, California

Los Angeles passed laws that allowed for the conversion of motels into permanent supportive housing, regardless of current zoning jurisdictions. This was implemented to aid the homeless population (Reyes, 2018). Specifically, the first law allowed for certain buildings that were categorized under the requirements of homeless housing projects would not entail an environmental assessment (2018). The ordinance is also 'slashing' parking requirements and allowing these projects to be built taller and denser than otherwise allowed (2018). The second law is allowing motels to be converted temporarily into housing much faster than previously allowed (2018). Ultimately, motels were deemed to be underutilized and this alternative housing strategy allows for a quick and inexpensive solution to housing the homeless. The Cecil Hotel is a notable example of this sort of revitalization. The building was renovated, and many rooms were converted into social housing units to combat homelessness (CBSLA, 2021). This could be done for any abandoned or underutilized buildings in Cambridge, and it would cost less than a new development for affordable housing.

We would advise the City to explore housing options for homeless individuals with alternative solutions such as those presented in Los Angeles, because homelessness is a very prevalent and expensive concern in Canada. For example, in 2013 homelessness cost the Canadian economy over 7 billion dollars (Gaetz et al., 2017). We would advise that the City explores this option further to improve on the current situation of homelessness in Cambridge. Specifically, considering the effects COVID-19 has had on the capacity limits of emergency shelters and transitional housing. When looking for immediate solutions and considering the financial costs of homelessness, this solution is viable.

### Lessons Learned:

In the case for revitalization, we realize that finding previously zoned multifamily development will not always be feasible, thus the City will need to establish some unique alternatives to address the missing middle and affordable housing. The City can re-utilize any vacant infrastructure (Bristol), use shipping containers as affordable housing units (Bristol), or re-utilize motels or hotels to address homelessness (Los Angeles). However, Table 11 shows the necessary steps the City will need to take as to ensure the success of this recommendation. First is to build financial capacity, which we have identified later in the report (Policies). Secondly, we advise the City to turn towards partnerships as a way to build capacity for the implementation stage. This will ensure that there is clear comprehension and preparation for any of the undertakings. We have also prepared a few sample locations where revitalization projects could occur in Cambridge Table 12. Finally, we would advise the City to explore the listed supplementary programs to aid in the process of overcoming any socio-economic hurdles.



Table 11: Strategic Analysis of Revitalization

| Procedure                                     | Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|-----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Step 1: Research</b>                       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Long range planning with regards to housing stock</li> <li>Site identification</li> <li>Investigate alternative housing options (Bristol, L.A.)</li> </ul>                                                                      |
| <b>Step 2: Identify Funding Opportunities</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Apply for revitalization grants</li> <li>Create capital programs to support housing renewal and expansion</li> </ul>                                                                                                            |
| <b>Step 3: Strengthen Partnerships</b>        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Strong relationship and collaboration between the City and the Housing Corporation</li> <li>Build capacity with private-public partnerships (extensive planning stage to ensure clear comprehension and preparation)</li> </ul> |
| <b>Step 4: Implementation</b>                 | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Delivery of supplementary programs</li> <li>Construction</li> <li>Create policy to account for long term sustainability</li> </ul>                                                                                              |

Table 12: Potential Locations for Revitalization

| Type                  | Latitude    | Longitude    | Address                                   |
|-----------------------|-------------|--------------|-------------------------------------------|
| Abandoned House       | 43.340423   | -80.271209   | 96 Branchton Rd, Cambridge, ON N1R 5S2    |
| Land                  | 43.452038   | -80.294031   | Cambridge, ON N3C 2V3                     |
| Abandoned Foundations | 43.43184728 | -80.40110363 | NA                                        |
| Abandoned Other       | 43.43981334 | -80.3854394  | 4320 Fountain St N, Cambridge, ON N3H 4R7 |
| Abandoned House       | 43.369243   | -80.367452   | N/A/                                      |

### Los Angeles, USA

Los Angeles has a younger population demographic than that of Cambridge. These two locations have relatively similar numbers, although the major difference is with young adults. Specifically, the largest age groups for Los Angeles are ages 20-29 and 30-39, which are both very similar in totals (Census Reporter, 2019). Combined, these two groups make up 33.15% of the population, which is 8% higher than the same age group for Cambridge. Also, Los Angeles has a smaller population aged 40-59 with only 25% in this group, which is approximately 4% lower than Cambridge.

Regarding education, there are far more highly educated individuals in Los Angeles. A breakdown can be seen in Figure 25. Notably, the number of people who have obtained a post-graduate or bachelor's degree in Los Angeles is much higher than in Cambridge. Combined, the total is 35.80%, compared to 10.86% in Cambridge. However, there are many more people who have not obtained a degree in Los Angeles, with 6% more reporting this in the census (Census Reporter, 2019).

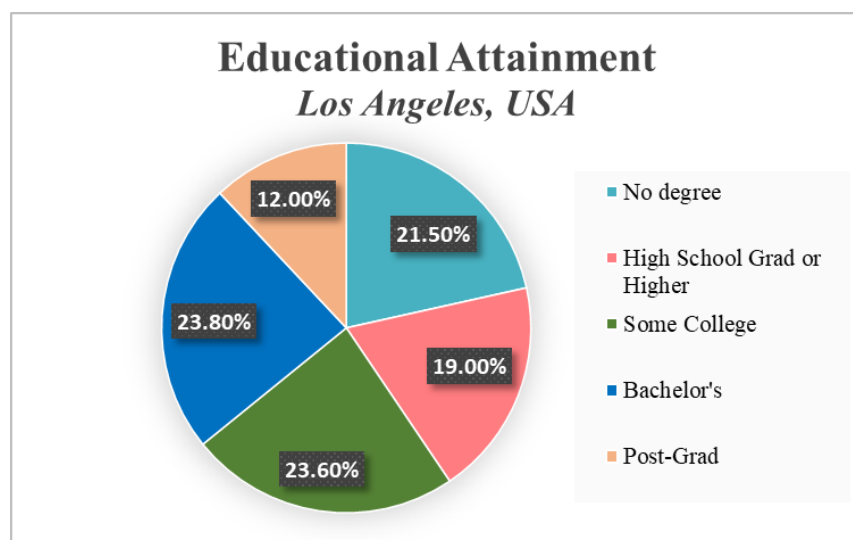


Figure 25: Pie graph showing the educational attainment for Los Angeles, (Census Reporter, 2019).

For American cities, household income has been adjusted to the Canadian Dollar, resulting in different categorical values, which is shown in Figure 26. Interestingly, the highest value for Los Angeles falls in the 'Under \$63,445' category with 38.40% of people reporting this as their household income. Certainly, there are far more people with lower incomes in Los Angeles than Cambridge, which is important when looking at how successful their recommendations for affordable housing have been.

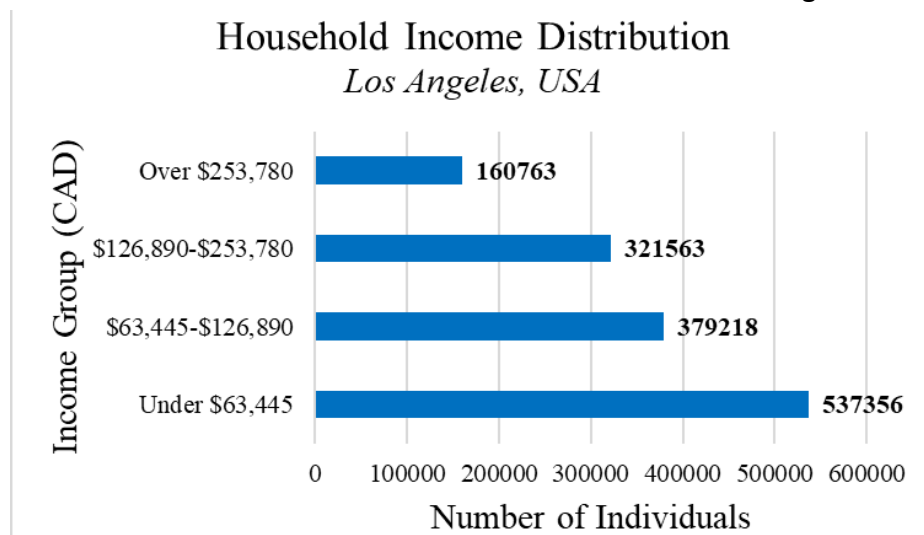


Figure 26: Bar graph showing the household income distribution in Los Angeles, converted to CAD, (Census Reporter, 2019).

It is worth mentioning that in Los Angeles, people who identify as Hispanic makeup 48.20% of the population, while the White population only makes up 28.70%. These values are very different from Cambridge, which is majorly White. Latin, Central and South American individuals only make up 1.77% in Cambridge, which is the comparable category, as the United States reported ethnicity slightly different than Canada (Census Reporter, 2019).

## ***Policies***

The Affordable Housing Community Improvement Plan is Cambridge's plan to bring in affordable housing investors. There are incentives such as waiving planning application fees and providing tax increment grants to eligible projects. These incentives would encourage investors to build affordable housing in Cambridge and would help with private-public partnerships.

The Affordable Housing Innovation Fund is a \$200 million fund with the goal of creating up to 4,000 affordable units. This fund encourages innovative projects tied to affordable housing. To be eligible for this fund there must be an innovative approach to affordable housing such as repurposing vacant properties and converting them to affordable units. This fund prioritizes projects that bring in more partners, additional investment, and address the needs of vulnerable populations. Using this fund, Cambridge could revitalize apartment buildings and turn them into affordable housing or find creative ways to create affordable housing such as tiny homes using shipping containers mentioned in the Bristol case study.

The CMHC has a fund called the National Co-Investment Fund which has two different options: new construction and revitalization. Both options offer low-cost or forgivable loans, depending on the needs of investors and what the project entails. An applicant would apply for the new construction strand if building a completely new structure and the revitalization strand if renovating an existing building. This fund will prioritize projects that are accessible, energy- efficient, affordable, socially inclusive, and are close to transit and other amenities. Further policy analysis can be found in Appendix E.

## ***Finding 4: Supplementary Programs (Build Capacity with Non-Profit Housing and Services Providers)***

Building partnerships and capacity, especially with services providers is ideal for the City of Cambridge in providing affordable housing. We have gathered five supplementary programs which will provide housing stability by developing social services targeted towards the educational curriculum, childcare, mental health services, food insecurity, and energy rebates. Each recommendation will provide socioeconomic benefits for both the residents and the City, as well as financial relief which will allow households to attend to immediate housing needs.

### **Best Practice: Energy Saving Rebates**

Our research has pointed to rebate programs as a way to decrease household expenditures, as well as decrease the financial hurdle in which the City may face when implementing our revitalization strategy. To

implement this program, the City should focus on strengthening partnerships, all while supporting sustainable initiatives for long-term residents of older buildings.

Increasing amounts of research has shown the success of the usage of 'low-flow' utilities in both single and multi-family dwellings (Samarripas & York, 2019). In the United States energy rebate programs were created for low-income families to be able to afford new appliances and other energy efficient household items (2019). Many states collaborated with energy companies to offer these incentives to people, which is a great way to offset some of the costs. The American Council for an Energy-Efficient Economy (ACEEE) reported the key takeaways of energy saving rebate programs:

1. Affordable multifamily energy efficiency programs can achieve significant and cost-effective energy savings in both hot and cold climates.
2. Effective program designs for affordable multifamily housing feature practices like financing and incentives, technical assistance, collaboration among partners and stakeholders, and effective outreach.
3. The most important component of an effective affordable multifamily program is providing property owners and managers with technical assistance throughout the retrofit process.

Source: ACEEE

This could be adapted in Cambridge with partnerships with companies such as Enbridge, Enercare, and Reliance Heating, Air Conditioning & Plumbing. Canada has energy rebates which includes rebates on Energy Star certified appliances, and electric vehicle chargers. Examples such as this could be implemented in Cambridge, for example rebates on low flow toilets and smart thermostats. This would help offset costs for people purchasing these items and promote energy efficiency and eco-friendly items in the house.

### Best Practice: Food Programs

There is a correlation between households experiencing financial difficulties and limited household expenditures. As mentioned previously, fixed expenditures include rent and healthcare, non-flexible expenditures include transportation, utilities, and childcare, and flexible expenditures include clothing and food. Low-income households, especially with children, must make a difficult decision when it comes to choosing between housing, sustenance, and family services. Implementing food and childcare programs will provide effective solutions that will allow households and individuals the opportunity to attend to all three types of expenditures.

Moreover, we must consider the other alternative scenarios where food insecurity is equally as prevalent without the presence of children. These scenarios include households that may be facing eviction, homelessness, or reside in a disinvested neighbourhood where access to nourishing and affordable food is less likely. We will be investigating the continuous increase in food costs, how it affects households, the gap in nourishment, and strategies that can be considered by the city of Cambridge in order to improve the latter.

A 2022 food price report conducted by four universities in Canada (Dalhousie, Guelph, British Columbia, and Saskatchewan) outlined the 2022 food price forecasts and its anticipated cost changes (Figure 27). With a total increase ranging from 2-8%, residents are hindered by inflated costs but housing, employment, and income continues to remain low. Furthermore, the report suggested an annual food expenditure cost of \$14,767.36 for a family of four. (Figure 28). Assuming an individual earns anywhere between \$25,000 to \$30,000 annually, this takes up nearly half of their income (Charlebois et al., 2022).

### 2022 FOOD PRICE FORECASTS

| Food Categories                      | Anticipated Changes (%) |
|--------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| Bakery                               | 5% to 7%                |
| Dairy                                | 6% to 8%                |
| Fruits                               | 3% to 5%                |
| Meat                                 | 0% to 2%                |
| Other                                | 2% to 4%                |
| Restaurants                          | 6% to 8%                |
| Seafood                              | 0% to 2%                |
| Vegetables                           | 5% to 7%                |
| <b>Total Increase in Food Prices</b> | <b>5% to 7%</b>         |

Figure 27: 2022 Food Price Forecasts & Anticipated Changes

### TABLE 7: EXAMPLES OF CANADIAN HOUSEHOLDS AND PREDICTED ANNUAL FOOD EXPENDITURE 2022

| Household Demographics                                                                                 | Total Predicted Food Expenditure 2022 |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| Four People: Man (31-50), Woman (31-50), Boy (14-18), Girl (9-13)                                      | \$14,767.36                           |
| Three People: Woman (19-30), Boy (4-8), Child (1-3)                                                    | \$8,741.78                            |
| Four People: Two Women (31-50), Girl (14-18), Boy (9-13)                                               | \$11,716.62                           |
| Two People: Man (51-70), Woman (51-70)                                                                 | \$7,690.65                            |
| Six People: Woman (70+ Years), Man (31-50), Woman (31-50), Girl (9-13), Boy (4-8), Child (6-11 Months) | \$19,223.46                           |
| Two People: Man (19-30), Pregnant Woman (19-30)                                                        | \$8,704.24                            |

Figure 28: expected food expenditures

#### Summary of Key Factors to Success

- Establishing and strengthening partnerships with local and nationwide businesses
- Communal pantries & classes/courses
- Community gardens

**Food Program Case Studies:**

1. The *Beaver Creek Housing Co-op* in Waterloo has implemented a communal pantry, where residents can take or contribute as they can. This can be very helpful to assist individuals who may not possess enough funds to purchase groceries, or for those who do not have access to a grocery store at that desired moment. Additionally, *Beaver Creek Housing Co-op* provided a community garden to its residents, where individuals were able to grow, produce, and harvest edible plants. This allowed the community an active lifestyle, social opportunities, inclusivity, health and wellness, fresh produce, and sustainability.
2. *The Good Food, Good Medicine* organization in Barre, Vermont provided free cooking and gardening courses to two low-income neighbourhoods: offering insight on agriculture, harvesting, preservation, and herbalism through a community garden. It supported the “farm to plate” ideology, prompting residents to grow their own sustenance without the dependence of grocery stores and markets.
3. *The Breakfast Club Canada* is an organization that provides a daily, warm breakfast to elementary and high school students. The initiative is funded by government grants, donations, partnerships, and fundraising campaigns. Family households can gain financial reassurance knowing that their children are starting the day off with a nourishing meal.

**Best Practice: Child Care**

After assessing how food insecurity affects a household, we must consider the financial hurdles families may face once food costs are set aside. Child care can be a costly expense, yet it is vital to the financial success of a family as parents, or a single parent, must acquire child supervision before seeking employment. Fundamentally, both food insecurity and child care must be addressed in order to attain housing stability and community advancement for the residents of Cambridge.

“Child care is not a luxury, it’s a necessity. The past year has made it abundantly clear that we need affordable, accessible, inclusive, and high-quality child care, and we need it now. Leaders in the private, social, and labour sectors all agree that a Canada-wide early learning and child care system will drive economic growth, help women get back into the workforce, and give every child across Canada the best start in life.” (Hussen, 2021).

We will be mentioning the Quebec Model case study as a cautionary tale that was on track to succeed in sustainable, affordable child care but ultimately fell apart due to improper planning.

**Summary of Key Factors to Success (child care):**

- Tax deductions
- Tuition bursaries and skill/training reimbursements for workers
- Certification requirement



**The Quebec Model Case Study:**

*The Quebec Model* was an independent parental benefit program that was available to any parent who earned at least \$2,000 in the previous year; where eligibility was based on fixed income rather than number of hours worked. The program did not succeed, as it attempted to take shortcuts, which ultimately hindered the development of the child care system. It became difficult to attend to the high volume of demands due to insufficient labour and funding. However, we suggest that this could have been avoided through tax deductions, tuition bursaries, skill training reimbursements, and requiring a child-care certification for employment rather than the traditional degree.

**Best Practice: Mental Health Services**

Mental health & substance abuse plays a very important role in housing stability and the homeless population in Cambridge. It affects income, as it can have an impact on seeking or sustaining employment and introduces vulnerability.

**Summary of Key Factors to Success:**

- Build awareness, capacity, and accessibility
- Free mental health services via drop in hours
- Increased health & wellness services
- Identify funding opportunities

**The Bridges Case Study:**

*The Bridges Shelter* in Cambridge offers a 24/7 emergency shelter with sixty-four emergency shelter beds and twenty transitional bachelor apartments. The shelter has gained funding through private and corporate donations, as well as a loan of \$750,000 from the Region of Waterloo. Visitors from the shelter, and perhaps the shelter itself, can seek financial aid from the Federal Community Housing Initiative, which provides rental assistance or transitional funding to the most vulnerable groups. The shelter was able to successfully accommodate 150 homeless individuals with permanent housing since the commencement of the pandemic (Latif, 2022). After placing people on housing lists, they work with nearby landlords and group homes who rent out living spaces exclusively to individuals from the shelter. Additionally, the shelter offers a variety of services geared towards stabilization and helping individuals move forward, such services include:

- Mental health assistance
- Emergency stabilization → shelter, food, toiletries, clothing
- Financial management
- Health & wellness → medical clinic, referrals, vaccinations
- Identifications → birth certificates, health cards, SIN numbers/cards
- Addiction treatment referrals, individual addiction support, and relapse prevention groups
- Assistance finding housing
- Assistance finding employment
- Hair cuts
- Storage → lockers and mailboxes

It is important to increase awareness of these programs as there are individuals who could benefit from these initiatives but are unaware of their existence. Also, building capacity and accessibility to reach more individuals is vital, especially to those who are homeless or at the risk of being homeless.

Best Practice: Addition to High School Curriculum

Modern education includes teaching students the fundamental properties of mathematics, science, linguistics, history, geography, and arts. Additional courses such as business, economics, and law are optional. While there is a variety of core and alternative courses available, the curriculum excludes subjects regarding practical life skills. These life skills include, but are not limited to, mortgages, contract details, rental housing, and financial management. During our survey, Table 13, we inquired about additions to the high school curriculum and 84% of the participants responded with mortgages, followed by 80% selecting budgeting (Figure 29). This demonstrated an evident gap in the educational system, which directed our attention towards an adjustment to the current framework.

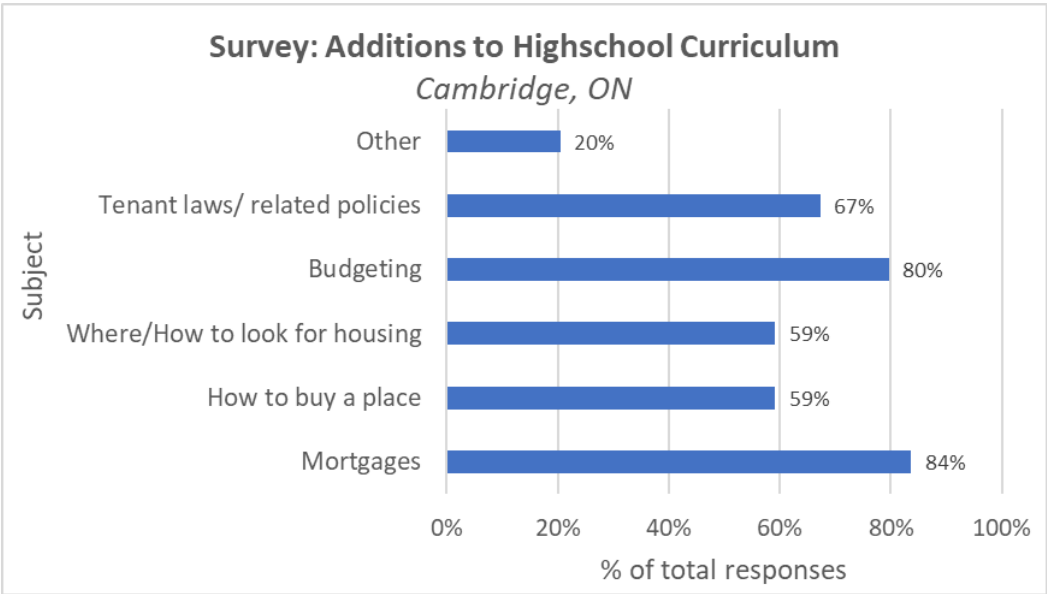


Figure 29: Survey Responses to Additions to High School Curriculum

Table 13: Survey Responses to Additions to High School Curriculum

| Mortgages | How to buy a place | Where/How to look for housing | Budgeting | Tenant laws/ related policies | Other    |
|-----------|--------------------|-------------------------------|-----------|-------------------------------|----------|
| 41 (84%)  | 29 (59%)           | 29 (59%)                      | 39 (80%)  | 33 (67%)                      | 10 (20%) |

Total responses = 49

Many students complete their studies with an underdeveloped knowledge of how to seek housing, understand the market, manage finances, and acquire/repay loans. As a result, they seek assistance from

their family, financial advisors, or a quick Internet search. However, it is significantly more difficult for someone to obtain additional support if they are categorized as a vulnerable group. These groups include immigrant, refugee, and low-income households that may face restrictions when seeking familial support, professional advising, or access to the Internet. This can create a gap in financial and housing management, as well as an understanding of human rights in a housing context.

Brokers, advisors, and agents experience complications when interacting with individuals still learning how to navigate the housing market. There is a fundamental lack of understanding for a generation that will ultimately drive the economy and real estate sector. An insurance company based in Toronto and the Ontario Justice Education Network (OJEN) collaborated to create a six-module resource named, *“A Foot in the Door: A Classroom Resource on Real Estate and Housing Law in Ontario”*. Ontario high school students will be provided insight that explores the housing framework to be applied to future life experiences. The six-model framework analyzes:

1. Negotiations and disputes
2. Budgeting
3. Rental housing
4. Buying and selling property
5. Mortgages
6. Human rights in a housing context

All six points aim to introduce students into the real estate market and grant a younger generation the knowledge to responsibly secure a home. Eventually, students will be involved in the acquisition of one of the largest investments of their lives, therefore it is fundamental that this is executed properly (Horne, 2015).

#### Summary of Key Factors to Success:

- Introduce experienced advisors as guest speakers in educational establishments
  - Beneficial to advisors as community service, volunteer opportunities, and advertisement of services
- Initiate after-school programs with incentives for attendance
  - Course credit, improvements to academic standing (GPA/grade increase), beneficial to CV (curriculum vitae)
- Create a comprehensible financial and housing framework for the general public to access

### **Cambridge Zoning Changes**

Changes would need to be made to the zoning by-laws to accommodate our recommendations. The missing-middle issue would need to be addressed by incorporating mixed-use housing in the same neighbourhoods. Currently, detached one-family homes in Cambridge are allowed in 13 of the 16 zones, whereas the fourplexes or maisonettes are only allowed in 4 of the 16 zones (City of Cambridge, 2012).

Therefore, we would recommend changing the residential zoning by-laws to include more housing types in the same zones. For example, including fourplexes and duplexes in more zones to allow them in areas where only detached housing is presently permitted. Currently, some types of homes are available in many zones and others such as linear row houses are only available in a few zones, as you can see in Figure 30 and 31 below.

Missing middle is so prevalent in Ontario because zoning by-laws often do not permit multiple housing types in the same zones. However, cities such as Toronto are working on fixing this issue. Currently, Toronto has gotten rid of certain zoning requirements to make it possible to add secondary suites in homes including townhouses, eliminating minimum unit sizes, and decreasing parking requirements (Toronto Regional Real Estate Board, 2020). The City also expanded permission for laneway suites into all of Toronto and created a “missing middle pilot area” in the Beaches-East York neighbourhood (Toronto City Clerk, 2019). This pilot project will create missing middle housing in the Beaches-East York neighbourhood and test to see how well this works in this area. City staff have already surveyed residents of the neighbourhood and most of the respondents were happy with increasing the housing options in the neighbourhood to aid affordability and dwelling-availability in the city (Toronto City Clerk, 2019).

As for apartments, we would recommend up to three story buildings to accommodate the height limit by-laws. The recommendation comes from Sydney, Australia which has a law that allows up to three story buildings to be constructed without any additional consent. This will speed up the construction process and make it easier to build units that increase intensification. Currently, there are zoning restrictions in the Galt city centre between 15-34 metres, depending on the zone (City of Cambridge, 2012). Adapting this process would minimize development restrictions, additional paperwork, and applications for zoning changes providing benefits of increased intensification and development. To begin, Cambridge could change the zoning by-laws in Galt from the current 15-34 metres to 30-45 metres, depending on the zone.

With regards to revitalization and changing hotels or motels into apartments, there would need to be a change from commercial to residential use. A change in by-laws to allow hotels and motels to be repurposed and turned into residential units could potentially make the process easier. This could be compared to the residential units in commercial zones by-law under section 3.3.3 of the Cambridge Zoning By-law (City of Cambridge, 2012).

| Use Permitted |                                                                     | In Zone |     |    |    |    |    |    |    |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |
|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|-----|----|----|----|----|----|----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|
|               |                                                                     | RR1     | RR2 | R1 | R2 | R3 | R4 | R5 | R6 | RS1 | RD3 | RD4 | RD5 | RM1 | RM2 | RM3 | RM4 |
| (a)           | a detached one-family dwelling                                      | •       | •   | •  | •  | •  | •  | •  | •  | •   | •   | •   | •   |     |     |     | •   |
| (b)           | semi-detached one-family dwellings                                  |         |     |    |    |    |    |    |    | •   |     |     |     |     |     |     | •   |
| (c)           | a residential special care facility (subject to section 3.1.1.3(b)) | •       | •   | •  | •  | •  | •  | •  | •  | •   | •   | •   | •   | •   | •   | •   | •   |

Figure 30: Zones permitted for housing types (City of Cambridge, 2012)

| Use Permitted |                                                   | In Zone |     |    |    |    |    |    |    |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |
|---------------|---------------------------------------------------|---------|-----|----|----|----|----|----|----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|
|               |                                                   | RR1     | RR2 | R1 | R2 | R3 | R4 | R5 | R6 | RS1 | RD3 | RD4 | RD5 | RM1 | RM2 | RM3 | RM4 |
| (d)           | attached one-family dwellings (linear row houses) |         |     |    |    |    |    |    |    |     |     |     |     | •   | •   | •   | •   |
| (e)           | attached one-family dwellings (cluster row house) |         |     |    |    |    |    |    |    |     |     |     |     | •   | •   | •   | •   |
| (f)           | a detached duplex dwelling                        |         |     |    |    |    |    |    |    |     | •   | •   | •   | •   | •   | •   | •   |
| (g)           | semi-detached duplex dwellings (fourplexes)       |         |     |    |    |    |    |    |    |     |     |     |     | •   | •   | •   | •   |
| (h)           | attached duplex dwellings (linear)                |         |     |    |    |    |    |    |    |     |     |     |     | •   | •   | •   | •   |
| (i)           | attached duplex dwellings (cluster)               |         |     |    |    |    |    |    |    |     |     |     |     | •   | •   | •   | •   |

Figure 31: Zones permitted for various housing types continued (City of Cambridge, 2012)

## Conclusion

The purpose of this report is to review a wide range affordable housing initiatives used by municipal governments, and developers to address the missing middle. The recommendations and conclusions presented in this report are based on the best practices seen at both national and international scales as listed below. The scope of the research points to general conclusions on changing policies as to ensure the long-term sustainability of affordable housing. Ultimately, we present the City of Cambridge with a range of recommendations that are based on intensive social and economic analyses as to provide a holistic approach in solving the affordable housing crisis.

### Summary of Recommendations:

- Improve private-public partnerships
- Use of regulatory tools (Inclusionary zoning)
- Revitalization of existing infrastructure
- Explore innovative approaches (Container homes)
- Use of supplementary programs to increase affordability and accessibility
  - Energy Rebates
  - Child Care
  - Improvement of educational curriculum
  - Mental health services
  - Food insecurity

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## Appendix B: CV

# ARIANA MANSINGH

*Project Manager & Survey Coordinator*

### RELEVANT SKILLS

**Report-making:** previous experiences demonstrate the ability to create effective reports, synthesize information and consult various parties to increase project success.

**Effective communication skills:** as depicted through project experiences

**Proficient at Microsoft Office:** as demonstrated through research analytics experience

**Proficient at spatial analytics:** as a data analytics assistant

**Data extrapolation:** previous position as a research assistant demonstrates this skill.

**Python:** previous research assistant position requires a good understanding of python in order to extrapolate data for modelling.

### RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

**Research Assistant, 05/2021 to Current**

**ReSEC - Waterloo, ON**

Leading a project to address future implications of climate change on land use management utilizing compute modelling

Collection of both private and public data to synthesize for reports

Perform data assimilation to ensure data quality is up to standard

**Data Analytics Assistant, 06/2021 to 10/2021**

**Wilfrid Laurier University - Waterloo, ON**

Delivered reports to outside affiliates to communicate findings

Integrated recommendations from partner consulting agency

Critically analyze problems and provide potential solutions

**Campus Outreach Executive, 09/2021 to Current**

**EcoHawks- Waterloo, ON**

Collaborated with affiliates to achieve organization goals

Consulted various parties to achieve increased participation and project success.

Maintain contact with both members of the committee and outside affiliates to ensure all goals are met

### PROJECTS

**Research Presenter, 04/2020**

**Great Lakes Phragmites Collaborative - Virtual**

A collaborative project to address community problems through resource use analysis

Investigated success rate of current methods and communicated possible improvements

**Sustainability Consultant, 2018 to 2019**

**Woolwich Township- Waterloo, ON**

Generated sustainability and economic analysis of both current standing and suggested solutions

Produced a final report of community initiative solutions

### CONTACT

**Address:** 185 King St. N., Waterloo, ON

**Phone:** 647-300-2182

**Personal Email:** [amansingh@wlu.ca](mailto:amansingh@wlu.ca)

**Company Email:** [ecovital.ss@gmail.com](mailto:ecovital.ss@gmail.com)

**LinkedIn:** [www.linkedin.com/in/ariana-mansingh/](https://www.linkedin.com/in/ariana-mansingh/)

### EDUCATION

**Honors Bachelors of Arts Environmental Studies,** 2018 to Current

**Wilfrid Laurier University- Waterloo, ON**

**Option:** Geomatics

**Minor:** Sociology

**GPA:** 3.8 / 4.0

**Dean's Honour Roll, 2019/20**

### CERTIFICATES/ AWARDS

**AODA Integrated Accessibility Training, 07/2021**

Trained on the requirements of the Integrated Accessibility Standards Regulations

**TCPS 2: CORE, 06/2020**

Trained on the official research ethics policies of federal research agencies (CIHR, NSERC, SSHRC)

**NSERC Undergraduate Student Research Awards, 04/2021**

Received funding for undergraduate research in lake ice projections and climate change impacts.

**In-Course Scholarship, 10/2021**

Received funding for obtaining a high GPA



Figure 32: Ariana Mansingh CV





# JACQUELINE HAYNES

Communications & Sustainability Coordinator

## RELEVANT SKILLS

- **Public Speaking:** Had several public presentations, was comfortable and passionate about engaging the audience.
- **Microsoft Office:** Taken several courses requiring data analysis.
- **Customer Service:** Made every effort to make people comfortable and displayed success in past employment positions.
- **ArcGIS Products:** Took geomatics related labs at the University level
- **Leadership:** Was captain of intramural volleyball team, and coordinated community activities including the Christmas in Cambridge event.

## RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

### Outreach Associate/Research

Assistant, 03/2020 to Current

#### RARE Charitable Research Reserve - Cambridge

- Coordinated outreach efforts and effectively engaged the public
- Organized and provided notes for data collection and research
- Demonstrated loyalty, reliability, and rewarded for efforts

#### Sales Associate, 07/2019 to 08/2019

#### The Shoe Company - Niagara on the Lake

- Attentively listened to client needs and provided high end results
- Displayed multicultural awareness and helped using bilingual skills
- Demonstrated marketing and team effort making up to \$500 sales

#### Team Member, 03/2017 to 05/2017

#### Tim Hortons - Cambridge

- Engaged and listened to clients using interpersonal abilities to provide for their needs
- Swiftly adapted to solving multiple priorities at once, such as conflict resolution and stress management
- Accurately processed client transactions using POS

## PROJECTS

### Researcher, 04/2021

#### Great Lakes Phragmites Collaborative - Virtual

- Presented research and contributed new knowledge on the Spatial Analysis of Common Reed in Lake Bernard
- Networked within a professional setting to achieve the role

#### Sustainability Consultant, Winter 2019

#### Intro to Sustainability - St. Jacobs

- Collaborated with the township officials to enhance sustainable development within the community and proposed an innovative circular economic solution for community engagement
- Understood public needs and wants by meaningful engagement

#### Research Presenter, Winter 2020

#### Thesis Prep - Waterloo

- Collaborated with researchers at the Human Environments Analysis Laboratory (Both WLU and UWO)
- Understood provincial needs and proposed research to advance the commitment of policymakers making the COVID-19 recovery plan

Figure 33: Jacqueline Haynes CV

## CONTACT

**Address:** 16

Willow Avenue, Cambridge Ontario N1R2Z3

**Phone:** 905-246-9880

**Email:** [hayn2130@mylaurier.ca](mailto:hayn2130@mylaurier.ca)

**Business Email:** [ecovital.ss@gmail.com](mailto:ecovital.ss@gmail.com)

**LinkedIn:** <https://www.linkedin.com/in/jacqueline-haynes-1126b1210/>

## EDUCATION

### Honours

**Bachelors of Arts Environmental Studies,**  
2018 - present

**Wilfrid Laurier University - Waterloo**

- **Option:** Geomatics
- **Minor:** Archaeology and Heritage Studies
- **GPA:** 3.6 / 4.0

## LANGUAGES

- Fluent in English
- Fluent in French

## CERTIFICATES/ AWARDS

### NGO Certification, 04/2020

- Hands-on experience demonstrating knowledge and practical skills to engage in the community and build skills for a career.

### WWF Living Planet Certification, 09/2021

- Demonstrated skills, knowledge, and experience in leading and engaging others to take action for a more sustainable future.

### Entrance Scholarship, 09/2018

- 80% average entering University.





# GREG NELSON

*Economic Analyst*

## SKILLS

- **Customer Service** : Working with people and resolving service related issues, as well as adapting to the personalities of the customer.
- **Leadership**: Ability to oversee a team of individuals and role model success strategies, as well as training new hires.
- **Microsoft Office**: Proficient in Word, Excel, Outlook, and Powerpoint
- **ArcGIS Software**: Strong knowledge in ArcMap and ArcScene, QGIS softwares. Gained skills through geomatic-based classes

## EXPERIENCE

### Customer Service

**Supervisor**, 06/2021 to Current

**The Brick** - Kitchener, ON

- Worked in a fast paced environment, balancing multiple tasks at a time
- Responded to customer inquiries, involving status of orders, service, and warranty claims through critical thinking and conflict resolving
- Coordinated information with staff, such as changes in product availability and delivery schedules

**Residence Life Don**, 04/2019 to 04/2020

**Wilfrid Laurier University** - Waterloo, ON

- Organized community events to encourage community integration
- Supported first year student transition to university through upholding residence policy
- Worked collaboratively with a team by attending programming events and providing feedback
- Reflected on personal achievement and confidential student achievement

**Sales Associate**, 07/2016 to 08/2019

**Staples Business Depot** - North Bay, ON

- Assisted in training new hires on organizational procedures, policies, and sales techniques
- Arranged merchandise for display to highlight new styles, attract customers, enhance sales, and aid in marketing
- Implemented up-selling strategies, such as recommending warranties and accessories to increase sales revenue

**Assistant Bookkeeper**, 09/2017 to 01/2018

**VS Group** - North Bay, ON

- Reviewed and analyzed data information in Excel, highlighting important client information
- Entered bookkeeping information into programs such as Sage and QuickBooks

## CONTACT

**Address**: 54 High Street, Waterloo, ON

**Phone**: 705-491-5172

**Email**: [nels0260@mylaurier.ca](mailto:nels0260@mylaurier.ca)

**Company Email**: [ecovital.ss@gmail.com](mailto:ecovital.ss@gmail.com)

## EDUCATION

### Honors

**Bachelor of Arts Geography**, 2018 to Current

**Wilfrid Laurier University**- Waterloo

- Option in Geomatics
- **Major GPA**: 3.9
- **Dean's Honour Roll**: 2019-2021 achieving above an 85% average

## ACHIEVEMENTS

- **Specialist High Skills Major in Business** 2018
- **Top Customer Service Associate** - 09/2021-10/2021
- **In-Course Scholarship** - 2021
  - Based on Academic Achievement

## CERTIFICATIONS

**Accessibility for Ontarians with Disabilities (AODA)** 09/2021

- Integrated Accessibility Standards Regulation

**TCPS 2: CORE (Course on Research Ethics)** 04/2019

- Trained on Ethical Conduct for Research



Figure 34: Greg Nelson CV

# ALIA ESSIPOV

*Graphic Designer & Sustainability Coordinator*



## RELEVANT SKILLS

- **Public Speaking:** experienced & confident in public presentations and performances
- **Leadership:** guided and coordinated several after-school programs in secondary school, including; drama, dance, yearbook, Red Cross, Relay For Life, and Free The Children
- **Graphic/Multimedia Art Design:** proficient in photographic, digital, social media graphic, and video editing software
- **ArcGIS Software:** studied geomatic-related content through courses and labs

## EXPERIENCE

**Legal Receptionist,** 01/2019 to 01/2020

**Roos Law Personal Injury Lawyers** - Toronto, ON

- Welcomed visitors entering the establishment and guided them to their desired destination
- Arranged appointments with clients, while keeping records of the meetings in an organized manner
- Directed the flow of mail, faxes, and deliveries to reach the intended recipients
- Filed and organized legal documents into their designated location

**Beauty Service Provider, Educator & Supplier,** 03/2018 to Current

**Homebased** - Richmond Hill, ON

- Individually operated a beauty service business to customer satisfaction
- Trained and certified over twenty individuals, offering lifetime mentorship and support
- Marketed and sold products to other beauty and cosmetic establishments, supplying wholesale quantities

**Cashier, Sales Associate,** 11/2016 to 06/2017

**Bath & Body Works** - Vaughan, ON

- Worked in a fast-paced, energetic environment selling bath, body, and home fragrance products
- Assisted customers to ensure all needs were met while ensuring the weekly sales quota was achieved
- Accurately processed customer transactions and maintained the cash drawer through a Shopify system

Figure 35: Alia Essipov CV

## CONTACT

**Address:** 8 Hickory Street West, Waterloo, Ontario, N2L 3H6

**Phone:** 647-990-4715

**Email:** [essi7920@mylaurier.ca](mailto:essi7920@mylaurier.ca)

**Company Email:** [ecovital.ss@gmail.com](mailto:ecovital.ss@gmail.com)

## EDUCATION

**Honours Bachelors of Arts**

**Environmental Studies,** 2018 to Current

**Wilfrid Laurier University** - Waterloo, ON

- **Minor:** Religion and Culture

## LANGUAGES

- Fluent in English
- Fluent in French
- Fluent in Russian

CERTIFICATES/  
AWARDS

- **First Aid & CPR Certification (2015)** - trained and certified for First Aid & CPR through *Canada CPR*
- **French Academic Award (2016)** - showed outstanding performance in French Immersion course
- **Top Seller of the Month (2017)** - rewarded by *Bath & Body Works* for producing the highest sales of the month
- **Dean's List (2018-2020)** - achieving above an 85% average in post-secondary studies



# SYDNEY PORTE

*Research Analyst & Policy Analyst*

## PROFILE

- **Communication/Problem Solving:** helped customers with various questions about the company and products at Ridgeway Lavender
- **GIS software:** proficient in ArcGIS and ArcMaps through university courses
- **Writing/ Research Skills:** assignments such as reports, research articles, persuasive essays through various courses at Wilfrid Laurier University
- **Teamwork/Collaboration:** worked as team lead or part of a team at the City of Port Colborne and Ridgeway Lavender Inc.

## RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

**Environmental Compliance Student,** 05/2021 to 09/2021

**City of Port Colborne-** Port Colborne, ON

- Prepared documents, PowerPoints, and Excel files to aid further analysis from supervisors
- Generated a report to be taken to council and implemented into the city plan
- Created new plans and educational materials for the environmental compliance division

**Administrative Assistant,** Summer 2020

**Ridgeway Lavender Inc.** – Port Colborne, ON

- Aided in preparing and organizing new store
- Sent emails to various organizations
- Managed social media accounts

**Floor Representative,** 09/2018 to 04/2019

**House Council, Wilfrid Laurier University** - Waterloo

- Communicated with students about events they would like or ideas they have
- Marketed to students about events held by house council
- Kept records at weekly meetings discussing future ideas and functions

## PRESENTATIONS

**Research Consultant,** Winter 2019

**Wilfrid Laurier University** – Waterloo, ON.

- Presented sustainable upgrades to the township of Woolwich
- Liaison with Business Improvement Area and council members of the Township of Woolwich to find solutions to sustainability related problems
- Researched unique ways to solve sustainability issues in Woolwich

**Panelist in Co-op Speaker Series,** November 2021

**Wilfrid Laurier University** - Waterloo, ON.

- Gave advice to lower year students on attaining co-op positions
- Answered any questions students had for best practices and skills to receive co-op jobs

*Figure 36: Sydney Porte CV*

## CONTACT

**Address:** 2181

Killaly St E, Port Colborne ON

**Phone:** 905-931-1140

**Email:** [port9110@mylaurier.ca](mailto:port9110@mylaurier.ca)

**Work Email:** [ecovital.ss@gmail.com](mailto:ecovital.ss@gmail.com)

**LinkedIn:**

<https://www.linkedin.com/in/sydney-porte-401624204/>

## EDUCATION

**Bachelor of Arts**

**Environmental Studies,** 2018 to Current

**Wilfrid Laurier University-** Waterloo, ON.

- Co-op program

## CERTIFICATIONS

**TCPS 2: CORE, 10/2020**

- Certified in Research Ethics policies and able to conduct interviews

**OMAFRA: Water and Soil Best**

**Management Practices, 07/2020**

- Ontario government best practice options to keep healthy soils and environmentally conscious watering techniques



# Appendix C: Survey

## Cambridge

How would you rate the following in Cambridge?

|                                | Terrible              | Poor                  | Average               | Good                  | Excellent             |
|--------------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|
| Quality of life                | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> |
| Access to affordable housing   | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> |
| Ability to get around on foot  | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> |
| Public transportation          | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> |
| Overall appearance of the city | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> |
| Job opportunities              | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> |
| Safety                         | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> |
| Parking availability           | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> |

How would you rank the amount of construction?

|                       |                       |                       |                       |                       |                       |                       |                       |                       |                       |                       |
|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|
| Very little           |                       |                       |                       |                       | Average               |                       |                       |                       |                       | A lot                 |
| 0                     | 1                     | 2                     | 3                     | 4                     | 5                     | 6                     | 7                     | 8                     | 9                     | 10                    |
| <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> |

Could you explain your reasoning?

How would you rank the amount of preservation? (e.g. The conservation/maintenance of heritage sites/historic buildings)

| Very little           |                       |                       |                       |                       | Average               |                       |                       |                       |                       |                       | A lot |
|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-------|
| 0                     | 1                     | 2                     | 3                     | 4                     | 5                     | 6                     | 7                     | 8                     | 9                     | 10                    |       |
| <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> |       |

Could you explain your reasoning?

On a scale of 0-10, how willing are you to have affordable housing in your area?

**Affordable housing:** is housing that meets the needs of those with low to moderate income and is priced so 30% of income goes to rent/housing

| Very Against          |                       |                       |                       |                       |                       |                       |                       |                       |                       | Very Willing          |
|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|
| 0                     | 1                     | 2                     | 3                     | 4                     | 5                     | 6                     | 7                     | 8                     | 9                     | 10                    |
| <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> |

How would you feel if social housing was implemented into your neighbourhood? What are your concerns?

**Social housing:** defined as government-assisted housing, provides rental units at a lower cost

How would you feel if affordable rental housing/affordable home ownership was implemented into your neighbourhood? What are your concerns?

**Affordable rental housing/affordable home ownership:** a household that spends less than 30 percent of pre-tax income on housing

## Housing

Which type of housing do you currently live in?

- ☐ Apartment
- ☐ Single-Family Home
- ☐ Duplex
- ☐ Condominium
- ☐ Unhoused
- ☐ Other:

Which of the following best describes your current housing situation?

- ☐ Homeowner
- ☐ Sole renter
- ☐ Living with others but not paying rent or mortgage
- ☐ Living with others and assisting with paying rent or mortgage
- ☐ Unhoused
- ☐ Other:

You selected "Living with others but not paying rent or mortgage". Please answer the following questions in number format (1, 2, etc.)

How many other people reside in your household (including self)?

How many people are assisting in paying rent/mortgage?

You selected "Living with others and assisting with paying rent or mortgage". Please answer the following questions in number format (1, 2, etc.)

How many other people reside in your household (including self)?

How many people are assisting in paying rent/mortgage (including self)?

Are you satisfied with your current living arrangements?

- ☐ Extremely satisfied
- ☐ Somewhat satisfied
- ☐ Neither satisfied nor dissatisfied
- ☐ Somewhat dissatisfied
- ☐ Extremely dissatisfied



Why are you neutral/dissatisfied with your living arrangements. Select all that apply.

- ☐ Home/Apartment needs repairs that I cannot afford
- ☐ Landlord won't make repairs
- ☐ Property Value Fell
- ☐ Foreclosure Concerns
- ☐ Bad/Rude/Loud Neighbors
- ☐ Crime in Neighborhood
- ☐ Too expensive
- ☐ Other:

What factors are most important to you when choosing your home or apartment? Select all that apply.

- ☐ Cost I can afford
- ☐ Close to bus/transit stops
- ☐ Close to services
- ☐ Close to work
- ☐ Close to shopping
- ☐ Close to family/friends
- ☐ Close to schools
- ☐ Close to health care facilities
- ☐ I/We are disabled and require accessibility
- ☐ Low Crime Rate
- ☐ Like the Neighborhood
- ☐ Number of Bedrooms
- ☐ Good building management/landlord
- ☐ Yard Size
- ☐ Has desirable features (ex. Balcony). Please list features you look for.

- ☐ Other:

What are the barriers, if any, that keep you from living in another part of your community? Select all that apply.

- ☐ Nothing
- ☐ I don't want to live in another part of the community
- ☐ Can't afford to live anywhere else
- ☐ Don't have a car
- ☐ No bus service
- ☐ My race/ethnicity
- ☐ I'm disabled/no accessible housing elsewhere
- ☐ Other:

What areas can you think of that could be reused/repurposed for new housing (if you cannot think of a location you can skip the question)

Would it require renovations or demolition?

- ☐ Renovations
- ☐ Demolition
- ☐ A mix of demolition and renovations

Are there any development projects you're aware of? What is your opinion on these projects?

What do you wish was taught about housing in high school?

- ☐ Mortgages
- ☐ How to buy a place
- ☐ Where/How to look
- ☐ Budgeting
- ☐ Tenant laws/related policies/laws
- ☐ Other:

## Demographics

What is your gender?

- ☐ Female
- ☐ Male
- ☐ Transgender
- ☐ Non-binary
- ☐ Two-Spirit
- ☐ Other:

- ☐ Prefer not to say

How old are you?

- ☐ 18-29
- ☐ 30-49
- ☐ 50-64
- ☐ 65+

What ethnicity do you believe best fits you? (You can be specific as you like)

Which of these describes your personal income last year (post-tax)?

- ☐ \$0
- ☐ \$1 to 9,999
- ☐ \$10 000 to 24,999
- ☐ \$25 000 to 49,999
- ☐ \$50 000 to 74,999
- ☐ \$75 000 to 99,999
- ☐ \$100 000 to 149,999
- ☐ \$150 000 and greater
- ☐ Prefer not to answer

What is your total household income? (post-tax)

- ☐ Less than \$10,000
- ☐ \$10,000 to \$19,999
- ☐ \$20,000 to \$29,999
- ☐ \$30,000 to \$39,999
- ☐ \$40,000 to \$49,999
- ☐ \$50,000 to \$59,999
- ☐ \$60,000 to \$69,999
- ☐ \$70,000 to \$79,999
- ☐ \$80,000 to \$89,999
- ☐ \$90,000 to \$99,999
- ☐ \$100,000 to \$149,999
- ☐ \$150,000 or more
- ☐ Prefer not to answer

What part of the city do you live in?

Are there any insights you would like to provide us to aid in our research?

## Appendix D: Additional Survey Findings

Table 14: Responses to "Which type of housing do you currently live in??"

| Housing type       | Count |
|--------------------|-------|
| Apartment          | 18    |
| Single Family Home | 7     |
| Duplex             | 6     |
| Condominium        | 1     |
| Unhoused           | 1     |
| Townhouse          | 1     |
| Other              | 1     |

Table 15: Responses to "Which of the following best describes your current housing situation?"

| Housing Situation                            | Count |
|----------------------------------------------|-------|
| Homeowner                                    | 20    |
| Sole renter                                  | 15    |
| Living with others, not paying rent/mortgage | 2     |
| Living with others, paying rent/mortgage     | 20    |
| Unhoused                                     | 0     |
| Affordable Housing                           | 1     |

Table 16: Responses to "Are you satisfied with your current living arrangements?"

| <u>Living Satisfaction</u> | <u>Count</u> |
|----------------------------|--------------|
| Extremely satisfied        | 16           |
| Somewhat satisfied         | 16           |
| Neutral                    | 2            |
| Somewhat dissatisfied      | 9            |
| Extremely dissatisfied     | 8            |

Table 17: Responses to “Why are you neutral/dissatisfied with your living arrangements”

| Reasoning for neutral/dissatisfaction with living arrangements | Count |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|-------|
| Home/Apartment needs repairs that I cannot afford              | 3     |
| Landlord won't make repairs                                    | 6     |
| Bad/Rude/Loud Neighbors                                        | 1     |
| Crime in Neighborhood                                          | 3     |
| Too expensive                                                  | 12    |
| Small Unit                                                     | 2     |
| No Yard                                                        | 4     |
| Far from school                                                | 1     |

Table 18: Responses to “What factors are most important to you when choosing your home or apartment?”

| Important factors when selecting a home     | Count |
|---------------------------------------------|-------|
| Cost I can afford                           | 49    |
| Close to bus/ transit stops                 | 8     |
| Close to services                           | 15    |
| Close to work                               | 24    |
| Close to shopping                           | 13    |
| Close to family/friends                     | 20    |
| Close to schools                            | 10    |
| Close to health care facilities             | 14    |
| I/We are disabled and require accessibility | 1     |
| Low Crime Rate                              | 25    |
| Like the Neighborhood                       | 27    |
| Number of Bedrooms                          | 19    |
| Good building management/ landlord          | 19    |
| Yard Size                                   | 16    |
| Other                                       | 2     |

Table 19: Responses to "What are the barriers, if any, that keep you from living in another part of your community?"

| Barriers that keep one from living in another part of your community | Count      |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| Nothing                                                              | 11 (22.0%) |
| I don't want to live in another part of the community                | 12 (24.0%) |
| Can't afford to live anywhere else                                   | 28 (56.0%) |
| Don't have a car                                                     | 6 (12.0%)  |
| No bus service                                                       | 3 (6.0%)   |
| I'm disabled/no accessible housing elsewhere                         | 1 (2.0%)   |
| Low Vacancy                                                          | 2 (4.0%)   |
| Limited Options                                                      | 1 (2.0%)   |



## Appendix E: Additional Policy Breakdown

| Name                                                        | Description                                                                                                                                                                                                | Funding Amount                                                                               |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>CMHC: National Co-Investment Fund</b>                    | Women and children shelter and transitional housing, either for new builds or revitalization to be used by the end of March 2023                                                                           | \$250,000,000<br><br>\$200 mill. for capital funding<br><br>\$50 mill. for operational funds |
| <b>CMHC: National Co-Investment Fund - Revitalization</b>   | Either through repayable loans or forgivable loans (don't pay back) depending on eligibility                                                                                                               | \$3.46 bill repayable loans over 10 years<br><br>\$2.26 bill forgivable loans over 10 years  |
| <b>CMHC: National Co-Investment Fund - New Construction</b> | Repayable or forgivable loans based on certain cases such as lack of funding                                                                                                                               | \$5.19 bill repayable loans over 10 years<br><br>\$2.26 bill forgivable loans over 10 years  |
| <b>CMHC: Seed Funding</b>                                   | Interest free 3 year loans, for preservation or new construction (prioritizes environmental sustainability and vulnerable Canadians)                                                                       | CMHC determines this after you apply                                                         |
| <b>Federal Community Housing Initiative</b>                 | Rental assistance or transitional funding (only most vulnerable groups)                                                                                                                                    | Phase 1: \$38 mill<br><br>Phase 2: \$580.2 mill                                              |
| <b>Affordable Housing Innovation Fund</b>                   | Create up to 4,000 new affordable housing units<br><br>Affordable rental projects, affordable homeownership, and retrofit models                                                                           | \$200 million                                                                                |
| <b>Canada-Ontario Housing Benefit</b>                       | 355,000 repairs to social and affordable housing units<br><br>94,000 households receiving help to pay rent or make down payments<br><br>Must be living in community housing or eligible for social housing | \$168M invested in off-reserve Indigenous households since 2008                              |

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| <b>Canada-Ontario Community Housing Initiative</b>               | <p>Repairing and increasing supply of housing that meets people's needs</p> <p>Increasing efficiency by removing red-tape, improving coordination and helping offer sustainable housing</p> <p>Funding for service managers to replace social housing agreement funding that expires each year</p>                                                                                                                       | Does not mention                                                   |
| <b>Ontario Priorities Housing Initiative</b>                     | <p>Increase community housing supply</p> <p>Preserve affordable social housing including repair, renovation</p> <p>Provide affordability support e.g. housing allowances, rent supplements, home owner down payment assistance</p>                                                                                                                                                                                       | Does not mention                                                   |
| <b>Ontario Housing Supply Action Plan</b>                        | <p>2,100 to 5,500 new homes near transit</p> <p>Proposed changes to planning ac to bring housing to market sooner, help build housing, streamline planning approvals</p> <p>Exempting secondary suites in new homes from development charges</p> <p>Proposed changes to Ontario's building code and Education development charge framework</p> <p>Sell unused properties owned by the government to build more homes</p> | \$1.4M to hire more adjudicators to remove backlog of legacy cases |
| <b>Affordable Housing Community Improvement Plan (Cambridge)</b> | <p>Financial incentives to bring private investors in affordable housing (e.g. waiving applications fees for planning, building, signing; defer development charges; tax increment grant to properties within community improvement plan (CIP) * similar incentives for non-profit investment</p>                                                                                                                        | Does not mention                                                   |